Master Speaking

Abdul Raziq Nazari

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Foreword

This book was created with one simple belief: learning English is not only about learning what to say—it is about learning how to express what you think.

As your English develops, your conversations should become more than exchanges of simple information. You should be able to explain your ideas, question assumptions, disagree respectfully, tell meaningful stories, defend your opinions, and engage with ideas that do not have simple answers.

That is what this book is designed to help you do.

Throughout the book, you will encounter topics that are connected to the world around you: relationships, globalization, language, society, culture, and the challenges that shape our future. You will listen to authentic speakers, encounter different perspectives, learn useful expressions, discuss difficult questions, conduct research, and present your own ideas.

Try unfamiliar activities at your own pace. For prompts about personal experiences, you may answer generally, use an imagined example, or pass; you do not need to share private information.

Some questions will have no single correct answer. Some discussions may challenge what you already believe. Some videos may introduce ideas you disagree with. That is intentional.

Your English classroom should be a place where you can think out loud.

You may make mistakes. You may change your opinion. You may discover that someone else's argument is stronger than yours. You may even find yourself defending an idea you had never considered before.

All of these are signs that you are learning.

This book also asks you to take responsibility for your own progress. Don't wait for your teacher to give you every word. Don't memorize every answer. Don't be afraid of silence while you search for the right expression.

Your English will improve as you use it.

The journey starts here.

Turn the page—and let's begin.

Abdul Raziq Nazari

September 2026

How to Use This Book

A Practical Guide for Students

Welcome to Master Speaking, a course for developing English speaking skills.

This book is designed to help you use English to think, discuss, question, explain, argue, and communicate ideas.

The topics become increasingly challenging, but the goal is not to give you perfect answers. The goal is to help you become a more confident, independent, and thoughtful English speaker.

How Is Each Unit Organized?

Each unit is divided into four chapters.

Chapter 1 — Speaking through Reading

You will be introduced to the week's topic through questions, ideas, and activities.

- activate your background knowledge
- learn useful topic-related language
- discuss general questions
- share your personal experiences
- express and defend your opinions

Chapter 2 — Speaking through Listening

You will work with an authentic video or speech connected to the topic.

- watch and listen for meaning
- learn vocabulary from authentic English
- complete comprehension activities
- analyze the speaker's ideas
- discuss controversial or thought-provoking questions

Chapter 3 — Speaking through Discussion

This is your main communication day.

- collocations and phrasal verbs
- discussion expressions
- vocabulary activation
- group discussions
- ranking activities
- challenge questions
- spontaneous speaking

Chapter 4 — Speaking through Research Presentation

You will move from discussion to academic speaking.

- practice a pronunciation skill
- learn presentation expressions
- research a question
- organize your ideas
- use evidence and examples
- prepare a short presentation
- respond to questions from your classmates

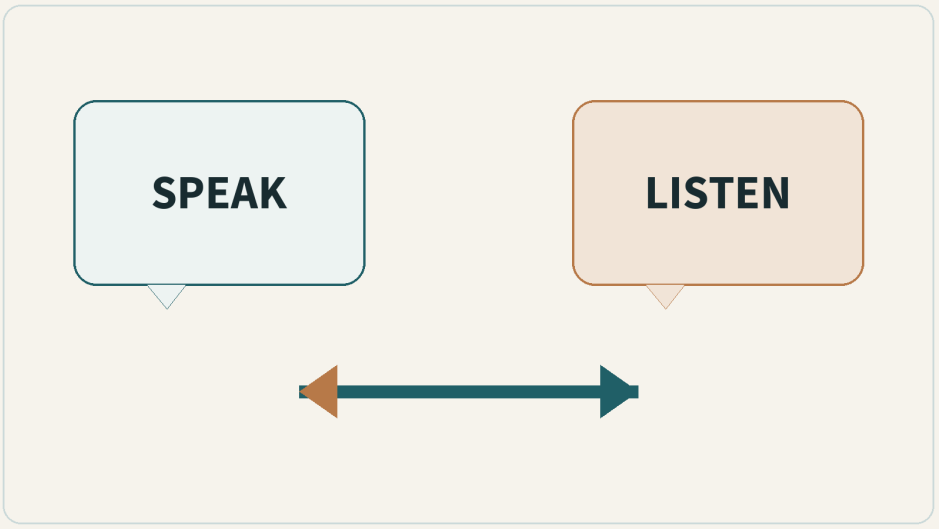
By the end of the unit, you should be able to speak about the topic in a structured and academically appropriate way.

Contents

Unit 1 · The Power of Communication **1**
Chapter 1 · The Power of Communication . . . 2
Chapter 2 · Are You a Good Listener? . . . 7
Chapter 3 · The Importance of Communication . . . 11
Chapter 4 · Speaking through Research Presentation . . . 14
Unit 2 · The Art of Goal Setting **17**
Chapter 1 · Dreams Become Reality through Goals . . . 18
Chapter 2 · The Art of Goal Setting . . . 24
Chapter 3 · Speaking through Discussion . . . 28
Chapter 4 · Goals or Systems: Which Leads to Greater Success? . . . 31
Unit 3 · Emotional Intelligence **35**
Chapter 1 · The Power of Emotional Intelligence . . . 36
Chapter 2 · The Power of Emotional Intelligence . . . 42
Chapter 3 · Speaking through Discussion . . . 46
Chapter 4 · Can Emotional Intelligence Be Improved? . . . 49
Unit 4 · Money and Happiness **53**
Chapter 1 · Can Money Buy Happiness? . . . 54
Chapter 2 · Can Money Buy Happiness? . . . 60
Chapter 3 · Speaking through Discussion . . . 65
Chapter 4 · Speaking through Research Presentation . . . 68
Unit 5 · Living with AI (Artificial Intelligence) **73**
Chapter 1 · Living with AI: Friend or Foe? . . . 74
Chapter 2 · How Will AI Change the World? . . . 80
Chapter 3 · Speaking through Discussion . . . 85
Chapter 4 · Speaking through Research Presentation . . . 88
Unit 6 · Is Love Enough? **93**
Chapter 1 · Is Love Enough? . . . 94
Chapter 2 · The Science of a Lasting Relationship . . . 100
Chapter 3 · What Makes Relationships Work? . . . 105
Chapter 4 · Speaking through Research Presentation . . . 108
Unit 7 · Globalization **113**
Chapter 1 · The World Is Getting Smaller . . . 114
Chapter 2 · Navigating Our Global Future . . . 120
Chapter 3 · Globalization: Opportunity or Threat? . . . 125
Chapter 4 · Globalization: Opportunity or Threat? . . . 128
Unit 8 · Lingua Franca **133**
Chapter 1 · English: From a Local Language to a Global Lingua Franca . . . 134
Chapter 2 · English Without Borders . . . 140
Chapter 3 · WHO OWNS ENGLISH? . . . 145
Chapter 4 · Speaking through Research Presentation . . . 148

Unit 1 ·

The Power of Communication



THINK

Answer the following questions individually.

What does communication mean to you?

Who is the best communicator you know?

Why do some people avoid speaking in public?

Chapter 1 ·

The Power of Communication

Speaking through Reading

Vocabulary Preview

Learn these words before reading.

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example Sentence
communicate	v.	to exchange information or ideas	Good teachers communicate clearly.
confidence	n.	belief in yourself	Practice builds confidence.
effective	adj.	producing good results	Eye contact is an effective communication skill.
audience	n.	people who listen or watch	The audience applauded loudly.
express	v.	to share thoughts or feelings	Students should express their opinions respectfully.
interaction	n.	communication between people	Classroom interaction improves learning.
Misunderstanding	n.	failure to understand correctly	A misunderstanding caused the problem.
persuade	v.	convince someone	She persuaded her parents to support her decision.
hesitate	v.	pause because of uncertainty	Don’t hesitate to ask questions.
message	n.	the main idea being communicated	His message inspired many people.

Vocabulary Check

Complete the sentences.

Good communication helps us _____ ideas clearly.

Never _____ to ask for help.

Teachers should encourage classroom _____.

Speaking regularly builds _____.

Every presentation has an important _____.

Before You Read

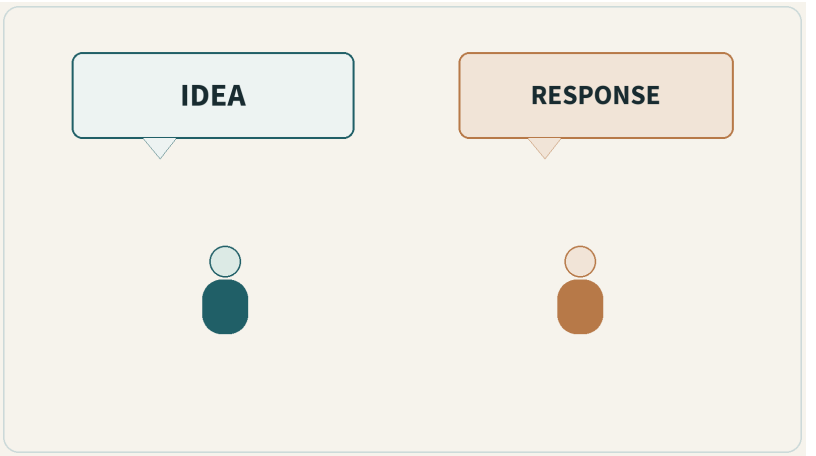
Discuss.

1. Which is more important: speaking or listening?

2. Do grammar mistakes stop communication?

3. What makes someone an excellent communicator?

The Power of Communication



Imagine living for one day without communication. You cannot ask questions, explain your ideas, express your feelings, or understand other people. Daily activities such as buying food, attending school, making friends, or working with colleagues would become extremely difficult. Communication is not simply a school subject; it is one of the most important life skills.

Many people believe that communication means speaking well. In reality, communication is much broader than speaking. It includes listening carefully, asking meaningful questions, understanding body language, writing clearly, and responding appropriately. Great communicators know that communication is a two-way process. They do not only speak; they also listen with attention and respect.

Unfortunately, many English learners believe they should remain silent until their English becomes perfect. This belief often prevents them from making progress. Language experts agree that mistakes are a natural part of learning.

Every conversation provides an opportunity to improve vocabulary, pronunciation, and confidence.

Consider two students. Ali knows thousands of English words but rarely speaks because he is afraid of making mistakes. Sara knows fewer words, but she participates in discussions every day. She asks questions, shares opinions, and accepts feedback positively. After several months, Sara becomes a much more confident speaker because she practices regularly. Ali, however, improves more slowly because he avoids communication.

Another important aspect of communication is listening. Good listeners do not simply hear words. They pay attention to the speaker's ideas, emotions, and intentions. They ask follow-up questions and show interest through eye contact and positive body language. As a result, people enjoy talking to them.

Communication also helps us solve problems. Families communicate to make decisions. Teachers communicate to explain lessons. Doctors communicate to understand patients. Business leaders communicate to motivate employees. Even scientists must communicate their research so that others can benefit from it. Without communication, knowledge cannot be shared.

Fortunately, communication is a skill that anyone can develop. Just like learning to drive, play football, or use a computer, becoming a good communicator requires practice. Every conversation, discussion, presentation, and interview helps us improve.

The next time you hesitate to speak English, remember one important idea: people are usually more interested in your message than your mistakes. Speak confidently, listen carefully, and continue learning from every conversation. Every great communicator was once a beginner.

Reading Comprehension

Choose the Best Answer

1. According to the reading, what is communication?

    a. only speaking English

    b. only listening carefully

    c. a combination of several skills

    d. only writing

2. Why does Ali improve slowly?

   a. He dislikes English.

   b. He studies too much.

   c. He avoids speaking.

   d. He has no teacher.

3. Why does Sara improve faster?

   a. She memorizes dictionaries.

   b. She practices speaking regularly.

   c. She never makes mistakes.

   d. She studies abroad.

4. Which statement is TRUE?

   a. Good communicators never make mistakes.

   b. Listening is an important communication skill.

   c. Grammar is more important than communication.

   d. Speaking is the only communication skill.

5. What is the main idea of the reading?

   a. Speaking perfectly is necessary.

   b. Communication develops through practice.

   c. Vocabulary is more important than listening.

   d. Reading is the only way to improve.

Answer the Questions

Why do many students avoid speaking English?
What can good listeners do?
How does communication help society?
Why is communication compared to learning football or driving?
What advice does the writer give English learners?

Critical Thinking

Work in groups. Discuss the following questions.

1. Do you agree that communication is more important than perfect grammar?

2. Which communication skill is your strongest?

Speaking

Listening

Writing

Reading

Explain why.

1. Can someone become successful without good communication? Why or why not?

Speaking through Reading

Activity 1: One-Minute Summary

Work with a partner.

Student A summarizes the article in one minute.

Student B listens and asks two follow-up questions.

Switch roles.

Activity 2: Find the Evidence

Work in small groups.

Find three ideas from the reading that support this statement:

Communication is a skill that anyone can improve.

Present your answers to the class.

Activity 3: Personal Connection

Complete the sentences.

The most important idea I learned today is

_____.

One communication skill I want to improve is

_____.

I will improve this skill by

_____.

Chapter 2 ·

Are You a Good Listener?

Speaking through Listening

Are You a Good Listener?

Think – Pair – Share

Discuss the questions with your partner.

1. What makes someone a good listener?
2. Have you ever felt that someone was not listening to you?
3. Which is more difficult—speaking or listening? Why?

Before Listening

Today's listening focuses on active listening, one of the most important communication skills.

Before watching, predict the answers.

1. What habits do good listeners have?
2. Why do people interrupt others?
3. How does listening improve communication?

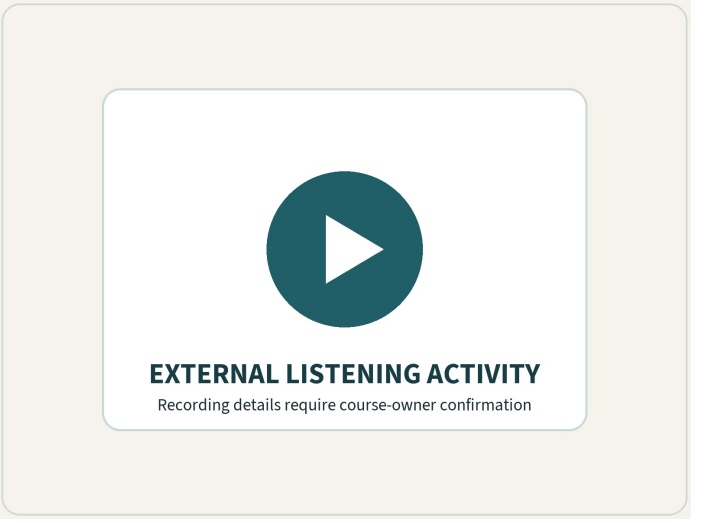
Here is a list of the most useful expressions to learn.

Expression	Meaning	Example
pay attention	to listen or watch carefully	Good listeners always pay attention to the speaker.
make someone feel understood	to help someone feel that you truly understand them	A good friend makes you feel understood when you share your problems.
go through the motions	to do something without real interest or effort	Don't just go through the motions when someone is talking to you.
remove distractions	to eliminate anything that takes your attention away	Before the meeting, everyone removed distractions by putting away their phones.

Expression	Meaning	Example
interrupt someone	to stop someone while they are speaking	It is rude to interrupt someone before they finish speaking.
ask open-ended questions	to ask questions that require more than “yes” or “no” answers	A good teacher asks open-ended questions to encourage discussion.
stay present	to keep your full attention on what is happening now	Try to stay present during conversations instead of thinking about your reply.
ask for clarification	to ask someone to explain something more clearly	If you don’t understand, ask for clarification politely.
keep an open mind	to be willing to consider different ideas or opinions	Good listeners keep an open mind even when they disagree.
change someone’s mind	to persuade someone to think differently	Listening respectfully is more effective than trying to force someone to change their mind.

Listening Strategy

First Viewing



Listen only.

Do not write anything.

Try to understand the main message.

Second Viewing

Take notes.

Main Idea	Supporting Details

Listening Comprehension

1. According to the speaker, what is the main purpose of good listening?
    a. To win every conversation.
    b. To make the other person feel understood.
    c. To give advice as quickly as possible.
2. What should you do before an important conversation?
    a. Remove distractions.
    b. Prepare a long speech.
    c. Check your phone often.
3. What type of questions should good listeners ask?
    a. Difficult questions.
    b. Open-ended questions.
    c. Personal questions.
4. What should you do if you lose focus during a conversation?
    a. Change the topic.
    b. Ask the speaker to repeat what you missed.
    c. Pretend you understood everything.
5. According to the video, good listening helps build
    a. competition and confidence.
    b. trust and stronger relationships.
    c. money and success.

A. True or False

_____ Good listeners should remove distractions before a conversation.

_____ Interrupting people often shows that you are interested.

_____ Asking for clarification shows that you are committed to understanding.

_____ Good listening always means agreeing with the speaker.

_____ High-quality listening can create a psychologically safe environment.

Group Discussion

Discuss the following questions in groups.

1. Why is it important to remove distractions before a conversation?
2. What are two ways to show that you are listening carefully?
3. Why are open-ended questions more effective than simple yes/no questions?
4. According to the speaker, why shouldn't you plan your response while the other person is talking?
5. What is one listening habit you would like to improve after watching this video? Explain your answer.

Homework

Listening Practice

Watch the video again. Without looking at your notes, record yourself giving a 90-second summary.

Chapter 3 ·

The Importance of Communication

Speaking through Discussion

The Importance of Communication

Speaking Toolbox

Study 10 carefully selected collocations, phrasal verbs, and discussion expressions related to the week's topic.

Expression	Meaning	Example	Your Turn
speak your mind	express your opinion honestly	Don't be afraid to speak your mind.	When is it difficult to speak your mind?
break the ice	make people feel comfortable	The teacher told a joke to break the ice.	How do you usually break the ice?
clear up a misunderstanding	solve confusion	We talked and cleared up the misunderstanding.	Describe a misunderstanding you had.
put your ideas into words	express thoughts clearly	She found it difficult to put her ideas into words.	When is this difficult for you?
make your point	express your opinion successfully	He made his point politely.	How can you make your point without arguing?
come up with an idea	think of an idea	We came up with a good solution.	Come up with a way to improve communication.
open-minded	willing to consider new ideas	Open-minded people learn from others.	Why is being open-minded important?
jump to conclusions	make decisions too quickly	Don't jump to conclusions.	Give an example.
take turns	speak one after another	Everyone should take turns.	Why is this useful?

Expression	Meaning	Example	Your Turn
support your opinion	give reasons	Always support your opinion with evidence.	Support one opinion now.
make a strong impression	create a positive effect	Good communication makes a strong impression.	How can students do this?
work things out	solve problems through discussion	They worked things out peacefully.	Describe a time you worked things out.

Vocabulary Activation

Work in pairs. Choose 10 expressions and create a short conversation using all ten.

Guided Discussion

Use the expressions above to prepare for the next activity.

Discussion 1

Communication at School

1. Why do some students hesitate to speak in class?
2. How can teachers encourage students to communicate more?
3. What makes classroom discussions successful?
4. Is making mistakes necessary for learning? Why?

Discussion 2

Communication in Daily Life

1. What communication skills are important in a family?
2. Have you ever experienced a misunderstanding? How did you solve it?
3. How can people become better listeners?
4. Why do some conversations fail?

Discussion 3

Communication and Success

1. Can communication change a person’s future?

2. Which is more important: knowledge or communication?

3. How does communication affect leadership?

4. What advice would you give shy English learners?

Speaking Challenge

One student speaks for two minutes answering this question:

1. What is the most important communication skill, and why?

Requirements:

Use five collocations or expressions from today's toolbox.

Give two reasons.

Give one personal example.

Chapter 4 ·

Speaking through Research Presentation

Pronunciation Clinic

Skill: Sentence Stress

Good speakers do not stress every word. They stress important words (content words) and reduce grammar words (function words). This helps listeners understand the main message.

Compare

I LIKE TO SPEAK ENGLISH WITH MY FRIENDS EVERY DAY.

(Natural? No.)

I like to SPEAK ENGLISH with my FRIENDS every DAY.

Practice

Read these sentences aloud. Identify and stress the key content words.

Communication is an essential life skill.

Good listeners ask follow-up questions.

Practice builds confidence.

Great speakers always respect their audience.

Clear communication helps people solve problems.

Presentation Toolbox

Essential Presentation Expressions

Learn these expressions before preparing your presentation.

Expression	Purpose
Good morning everyone.	Opening
Today I would like to talk about...	Introducing the topic
The purpose of my presentation is...	Stating the objective

Expression	Purpose
First, let's look at...	First point
Another important point is...	Adding ideas
According to my research...	Referring to information
For example...	Giving examples
As you can see...	Referring to visuals or ideas
To sum up...	Summarizing
Thank you for listening. Do you have any questions?	Closing

Write Your Research Presentation

Organize your ideas.

Step 1 – Write Your Title

Step 2 – Write Your Introduction

Introduce your topic.

Use one of the presentation expressions.

Example

Good morning everyone.

Today I would like to talk about effective communication.

The purpose of my presentation is to explain why communication is one of the most important life skills.

Step 3 – Organize Your Main Points

Write three main points.

Main Point 1

Supporting Detail

Example

Main Point 2

Supporting Detail

Example

Main Point 3

Supporting Detail

Example

Step 4 – Write Your Conclusion

Summarize your ideas.

Example

To sum up, communication helps us build relationships, solve problems, and succeed in our careers.

Thank you for listening.

Do you have any questions?

Rules

Speak for 3–4 minutes.

Do not read your paper word for word.

Maintain eye contact.

Speak clearly.

Use at least five expressions from the Presentation Toolbox.

Use at least five collocations from Day 2 or Day 3.

Unit 2 ·

The Art of Goal Setting



THINK

Answer the following questions individually.

What is one goal you want to achieve this year?

Why is this goal important to you?

What challenges might stop you from achieving it?

Chapter 1 ·

Dreams Become Reality through Goals

Speaking through Reading

Vocabulary Preview

Word	Meaning	Example Sentence
goal	something you want to achieve	My goal is to improve my English.
achieve	to succeed in doing something	She achieved her dream after years of hard work.
motivate	to encourage someone	Success motivates people to work harder.
determination	the quality of not giving up	Determination is essential for success.
obstacle	something that creates difficulty	Financial problems can become obstacles.
priority	the most important thing	Education is my top priority.
commitment	dedication to a task	Success requires commitment.
progress	improvement over time	I can see my progress every week.
strategy	a plan for achieving something	We need a better strategy.
realistic	practical and possible	Set realistic goals.

Vocabulary Check

Complete the sentences.

Hard work helps people _____ their goals.

Every student should have a clear _____ for studying.

Practice leads to _____.

Never lose your _____ when life becomes difficult.

Time management is an effective _____.

Before You Read

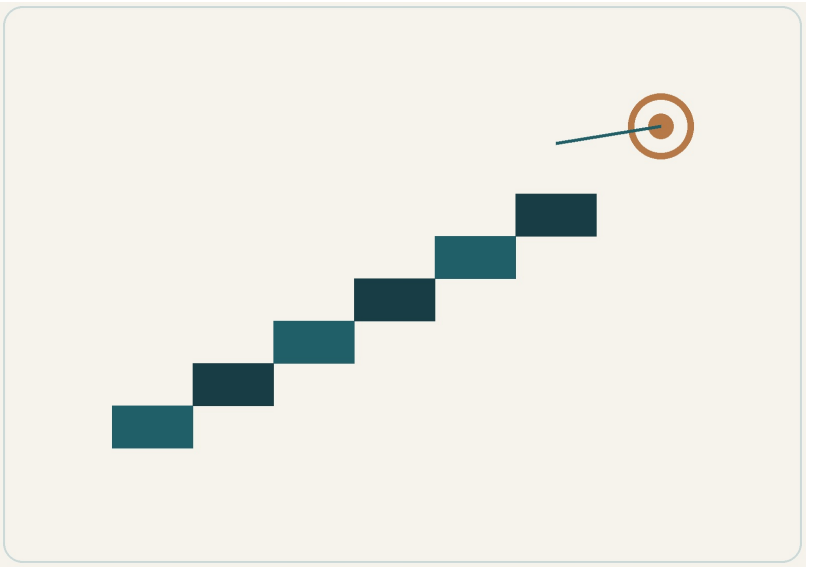
Discuss.

1. Why do some people achieve their goals while others give up?

2. Is talent more important than hard work?

3. Have you ever failed to achieve a goal? What happened?

Dreams Become Reality through Goals



Many people dream about becoming successful. Some want to become doctors, teachers, engineers, entrepreneurs, or professional athletes. Others hope to travel the world, learn new languages, or start their own businesses. While dreams inspire us, they rarely become reality without clear goals and consistent effort.

A goal is more than a wish. A wish is something we hope will happen, but a goal is something we actively work toward. Successful people understand this difference. They break large dreams into smaller, achievable steps and follow a plan every day.

Imagine two university students who both want to improve their English. The first student says, “I want to speak English fluently someday.” However, he has no study schedule and rarely practices speaking. The second student sets a clear goal: “I will learn 20 new words every week, read one English article every day, and speak English for 15 minutes after each class.” After six months, the second student makes much greater progress because his goal is specific and supported by daily action.

Setting goals also helps people stay motivated during difficult times. Every journey includes obstacles. Students may become busy with exams, employees may face pressure at work, and athletes may experience injuries. Without a clear goal, many people lose motivation and give up. Those with well-defined goals are more likely to continue because they know what they are working toward.

Another important aspect of goal setting is flexibility. Sometimes life does not go according to plan. Unexpected challenges may require us to adjust our strategy, but we should not abandon our goal completely. Successful people review their progress regularly, learn from mistakes, and continue moving forward.

One four-week study summary from Dominican University reports that participants who wrote goals achieved more than those who only thought about their goals. The highest achievement scores came from a group that wrote action commitments and sent weekly progress reports to a supportive friend. Only 149 of the 267 recruits completed the study, and the design does not show that writing alone guarantees success (Matthews, n.d.).

Finally, it is important to celebrate small achievements along the way. Reaching a milestone, completing a difficult task, or improving a skill reminds us that progress is possible. These small successes build confidence and motivate us to continue.

Remember, success is not the result of one big decision. It is the result of many small actions repeated consistently over time. A clear goal gives direction, but daily effort turns that direction into reality.

Reading Comprehension

Choose the Best Answer

1. What is the main purpose of the reading?

    a. To explain different careers

    b. To show why goal setting is important

    c. To compare successful people

    d. To describe university life

2. According to the reading, what is the difference between a dream and a goal?

   a. Dreams are easier to achieve.

   b. Goals require action and planning.

   c. Dreams are more realistic.

   d. Goals are only for students.

3. Why did the second student improve more than the first student?

   a. He was more intelligent.

   b. He studied abroad.

   c. He had a specific plan and practiced consistently.

   d. He spent more money on learning English.

4. According to the reading, what should people do when they face obstacles?

   a. Give up and choose another goal.

   b. Ignore the obstacles.

   c. Review their plan and continue working.

   d. Wait until the obstacles disappear.

5. Which statement is TRUE according to the reading?

   a. Successful people never face problems.

   b. Writing goals down can increase success.

   c. Goals should always remain the same.

   d. Small achievements are not important.

A. True or False

Write T for True and F for False. Correct the false statements.

_____ A goal is simply another word for a dream.

_____ Daily action is more important than having a dream alone.

_____ Obstacles mean you should stop trying.

_____ Successful people review their progress regularly.

_____ Sharing your goals with others may increase your commitment.

Answer the Questions

Answer in complete sentences.

Why are clear goals more effective than wishes?

What daily habits helped the second student improve his English?
Why is flexibility important when working toward a goal?
How can writing your goals help you succeed?
What is one lesson you learned from this reading?

Speaking through Reading

Activity 1: One-Minute Summary

Work in pairs.

Student A: Summarize the reading in one minute.

Student B: Listen carefully and ask two follow-up questions.

Activity 2: Ranking Success Factors

Below are six factors that help people achieve their goals.

Hard work

Clear goals

Good teachers

Family support

Self-discipline

Confidence

Task:

Rank them from 1 (most important) to 6 (least important).

Compare your ranking with your partner.

Explain and defend your choices using examples.

Activity 3: Personal Reflection

Complete the sentences.

One goal I want to achieve this year is

_____.

The biggest obstacle I may face is

_____.

Three actions I will take this month are

_____

_____

_____

Critical Thinking

Discuss the questions in pairs or small groups.

1. Do you agree that writing your goals increases your chances of success? Why or why not?
2. Which is more important: motivation or discipline? Explain your answer.
3. Have you ever achieved a difficult goal? What helped you succeed?
4. If you could give one piece of advice to someone who keeps giving up, what would it be?

Some people say, “Goals create pressure.” Others say, “Goals create direction.” Which opinion do you agree with? Explain.

Homework

Speaking

Prepare a 2-minute oral summary of today’s reading.

Chapter 2 ·

The Art of Goal Setting

Speaking through Listening

The Art of Goal Setting

Think – Pair – Share

Discuss the following questions with your partner.

1. Have you ever achieved a difficult goal? What was it?
2. What usually stops people from reaching their goals?
3. Which is more important for success: talent or hard work? Why?

Before Listening

Look at the Title

Why You Should Stop Setting Goals (Yes, Really)

Discuss.

Do you agree with this title?

Why might someone say goals are not enough?

What is the difference between a goal and a daily habit?

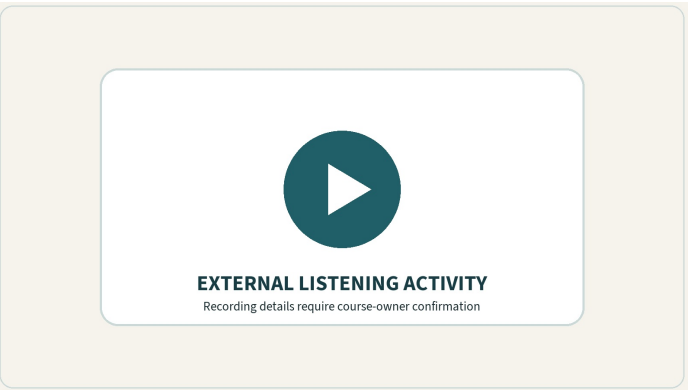
Focus on these useful expressions related to the talk.

Expression	Meaning	Example
set a goal	to decide what you want to achieve	I set a goal to improve my English speaking by the end of the year.
commit something to memory	to memorize something completely	She committed the important vocabulary to memory before the exam.
work tirelessly	to work very hard without giving up	The athletes worked tirelessly to prepare for the championship.
focus on	to give your attention to something	Instead of focusing on grades, I focus on improving my skills.
cause harm to	to damage or hurt someone or something	Working without enough rest can cause harm to your health.

Expression	Meaning	Example
go the extra mile	to make more effort than expected	Our teacher always goes the extra mile to help students succeed.
have an objective	to have a clear purpose or direction	My objective is to become a fluent English speaker.
be held captive by	to be controlled or limited by something	Don't be held captive by your fear of making mistakes.
believe in possibility	to think that success or improvement is possible	Successful people believe in possibility even when others doubt them.
reach your full potential	to become the best version of yourself	Education helps people reach their full potential.

Listening Strategy

First Viewing



✔ Do not write.

✔ Listen for the main idea.

Ask yourself:

1. What is the speaker trying to convince us to do?

Second Viewing

Take notes.

Focus on key ideas, examples, reasons. Do not try to write every word.

Main Idea	Supporting Details

Main Idea	Supporting Details

Listening Comprehension

A. Multiple Choice

Choose the best answer.

1. What was Emmanuel Acho's main goal in college?
    a. To become a sports psychologist
    b. To be drafted in the first three rounds of the NFL Draft
    c. To become a football coach
2. What happened during the NFL Combine?
    a. He tore his quad while running.
    b. He won the competition.
    c. He received a scholarship.
3. According to the speaker, why do many people set goals?
    a. Because they have been taught that goals are necessary for success.
    b. Because goals are always easy to achieve.
    c. Because goals eliminate failure.
4. What does Emmanuel suggest instead of setting goals?
    a. Avoid making plans.
    b. Have an objective without limitations.
    c. Change your goals every month.
5. What is the speaker's final message?
    a. Goals create limitless opportunities.
    b. Believe in possibility rather than being limited by goals.
    c. Success depends only on talent.

B. True or False

Write T (True) or F (False). Correct the false statements.

_____ Emmanuel wanted to leave college early and enter the NFL Draft.

_____ Emmanuel achieved his goal of being drafted in the first three rounds.

_____ The speaker believes writing goals down automatically guarantees success.

_____ Emmanuel says people often set goals because they want feedback.

_____ The speaker believes possibilities are greater than goals.

Group Discussion

Work in groups of 3–4 students. Discuss the following questions.

1. Do you think setting goals is enough to become successful? Why or why not?
2. Have you ever worked tirelessly to achieve something? What was the result?
3. What usually prevents people from reaching their full potential?
4. Do you agree that some people are held captive by fear or failure? Give an example.
5. What is one goal you have this year? What will you do to go the extra mile and achieve it?
6. Is it better to focus on the final result or on your daily habits? Explain your opinion.
7. Can trying too hard sometimes cause harm to your health or personal life? Why?
8. What is your biggest objective in learning English? How will you achieve it?
9. Think of a successful person you admire. Which expressions from today's lesson describe that person best?

Challenge Question

The speaker says we should believe in possibility instead of limiting ourselves with goals.

1. Do you agree or disagree? Explain your opinion with reasons and examples.

Chapter 3 ·

Speaking through Discussion

Speaking Toolbox

Study 10 carefully selected collocations, phrasal verbs, and discussion expressions related to the week's topic.

Expression	Meaning	Example
set high standards for yourself	to expect a high level of performance from yourself	Successful people often set high standards for themselves.
live up to your expectations	to achieve what you expected of yourself	I hope I can live up to my expectations this semester.
lose sight of your priorities	to forget what is most important	Many students lose sight of their priorities because of social media.
stay on track	to continue making progress toward a goal	A weekly study plan helps me stay on track.
push yourself beyond your limits	to challenge yourself to do more than you think you can	Athletes often push themselves beyond their limits.
turn setbacks into opportunities	to use failures as chances to improve	Successful people turn setbacks into opportunities for growth.
keep your long-term objective in mind	to remember your future goal while making daily decisions	Keep your long-term objective in mind whenever you feel discouraged.
maintain a sense of purpose	to continue feeling that your work has meaning	Having a clear vision helps people maintain a sense of purpose.
strike a balance between... and...	to give equal attention to two important things	Students should strike a balance between studying and relaxing.
take ownership of your success	to accept responsibility for achieving success	You must take ownership of your success instead of blaming others.

Vocabulary Activation

Work in pairs. Choose 10 expressions and create a short conversation using all ten.

Guided Discussion

Work in groups of 3–4 students. Use at least eight expressions from the Speaking Toolbox.

Discussion Questions

1. Why do some people achieve their goals while others fail?
2. Which is more important: talent or hard work? Why?
3. What bad habits stop students from succeeding?
4. Is failure necessary for success? Explain.
5. How can students stay motivated during difficult times?
6. Should parents set goals for their children, or should children choose their own goals?
7. What daily habits lead to long-term success?
8. If you could change one habit in your life today, what would it be?

Mini Debate

Motion

Success depends more on habits than goals.

Team A: Agree

Team B: Disagree

Each student should speak for one minute.

Speaking Challenge

Individual Presentation (2 Minutes)

Topic:

The One Habit That Could Change My Life

Include:

your current habit

why it should change

your action plan

expected challenges

how you will stay motivated

Chapter 4 ·

Goals or Systems: Which Leads to Greater Success?

Speaking through Research Presentation

Pronunciation Clinic

Skill: Thought Groups & Strategic Pausing

Professional speakers do not speak in one long stream. Instead, they divide their ideas into thought groups, pausing briefly between them. This makes their speech easier to understand and gives them time to think.

Example

✗ Poor Delivery

Success depends on good habits and everyone should build better routines because habits determine our future.

✔ Better Delivery

Success depends on good habits // and everyone should build better routines // because habits determine our future.

(// = short pause)

Practice

Read the following sentences aloud. Pause naturally where it makes sense.

Setting meaningful objectives // requires patience // persistence // and self-discipline.

Many successful people // focus on their daily systems // rather than short-term goals.

Failure should not discourage us // because every setback // provides an opportunity to learn.

Presentation Toolbox

Academic Presentation Expressions

Expression	Purpose
I'd like to begin by...	Opening a presentation
The purpose of my presentation is...	Introducing the topic
According to my research...	Referring to evidence
One significant finding is that...	Presenting key information
For instance,...	Giving an example
This suggests that...	Interpreting information
From my perspective,...	Giving a personal opinion
I'd like to conclude by saying...	Closing the presentation

Research Task

Topic

Goals or Systems: Which Leads to Greater Success?

Conduct research before your presentation.

Use at least three reliable sources, such as books, academic articles, TED or TED-Ed talks, university websites, interviews with successful people

Guiding Questions

1. What is the difference between a goal and a system?
2. Why do some experts believe systems are more effective than goals?
3. Can goals ever become harmful?
4. What habits do highly successful people have?
5. Which approach do you personally believe is more effective? Why?

Organizing Your Presentation

Prepare a 4–5 minute presentation using the outline below.

Introduction

Introduce your topic.

Explain why it is important.

Body

Explain the difference between goals and systems.

Present at least two research findings.

Give one real-life example.

Explain your own opinion.

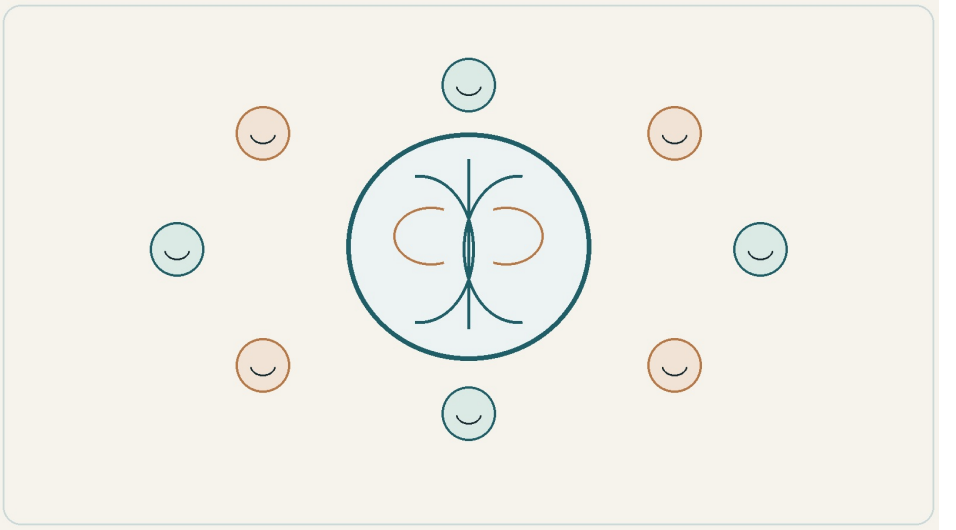
Conclusion

Summarize your main points.

Leave the audience with one final message.

Unit 3 ·

Emotional Intelligence



THINK

Answer the following questions individually.

How do you usually react when you are under pressure?

Is controlling your emotions an important life skill? Why?

Who is emotionally intelligent—someone with a high IQ or someone who understands people well?

Can emotional intelligence be learned, or are people born with it?

Chapter 1 ·

The Power of Emotional Intelligence

Speaking through Reading

Vocabulary Preview

Expression	Meaning	Example
reliable predictor of success	something that accurately indicates future success	Hard work is often a more reliable predictor of success than natural talent.
challenge an assumption	to question a commonly accepted belief	Recent studies have challenged the assumption that money guarantees happiness.
respond appropriately to	to react in a suitable or effective way	Good leaders respond appropriately to criticism.
build meaningful relationships	to develop strong and valuable relationships	Emotional intelligence helps people build meaningful relationships.
resolve conflicts	to solve disagreements peacefully	Managers should know how to resolve conflicts within a team.
under pressure	in a stressful or difficult situation	She remains calm even under pressure.
cope with stress	to deal successfully with stress	Exercise helps many people cope with stress.
constructive feedback	helpful advice that helps someone improve	Teachers should provide constructive feedback to their students.
conscious practice	deliberate and focused practice to improve a skill	Fluent speakers develop their skills through conscious practice.
interact with others	to communicate or work with other people	University students interact with others from different cultures.

Vocabulary Check

Complete each sentence using the correct expression from the Vocabulary Preview.

Speaking English every day is a form of _____.

Team leaders should know how to _____ before problems become serious.

Receiving _____ helps students improve their writing.

People who stay calm _____ usually make better decisions.

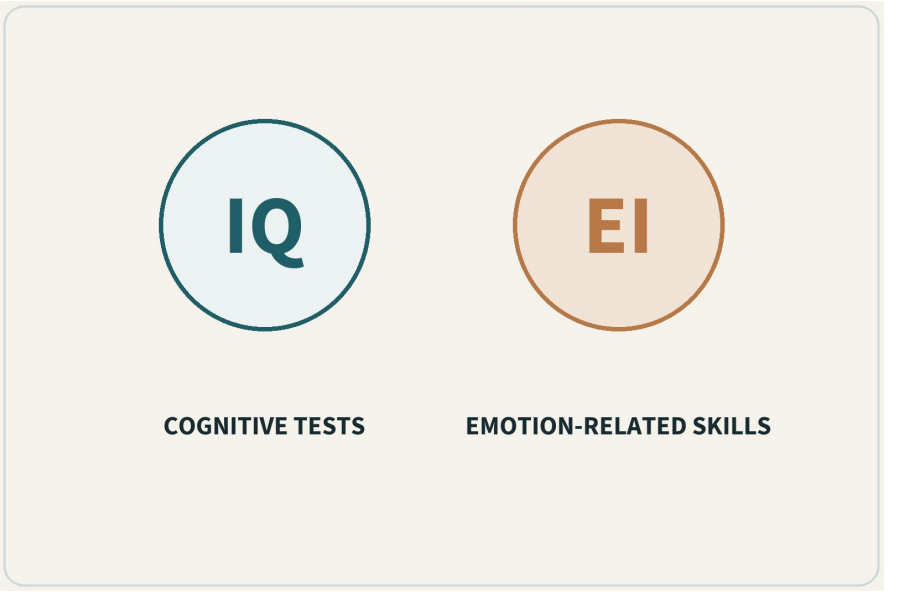
Learning another language allows you to _____ from different backgrounds.

Before You Read

Discuss.

1. What is emotional intelligence?
2. Why is it important in daily life?
3. How can emotional intelligence improve relationships?

The Power of Emotional Intelligence



IQ tests assess some cognitive abilities, while emotional intelligence (EI) is a separate construct with debated definitions and measures. Researchers continue to examine how EI measures predict real-world outcomes (Robinson, 2024).

Some models define EI as the ability to recognize, understand, use, and regulate emotions. Findings on how EI measures relate to relationships, conflict resolution, and decision-making vary; a high score does not guarantee success (Robinson, 2024).

Psychologist Daniel Goleman popularized one framework of emotional intelligence that describes five areas: self-awareness, self-regulation, motivation, empathy, and social skills (Goleman, 1995). The framework is not the only way researchers define EI (Robinson, 2024).

At work, skills such as recognizing emotional cues, listening, and responding constructively may support teamwork. They do not by themselves guarantee trust, motivation, or productivity; outcomes also depend on context and other factors.

In education, communicating clearly, collaborating, managing stress, and using feedback can support learning. None of these skills alone guarantees academic success; instruction, opportunity, prior knowledge, and other conditions also matter.

People can practise specific actions, such as pausing to identify a feeling, listening carefully, and choosing a response. Whether this should be described as improving "emotional intelligence" depends on its definition and measurement. Cognitive abilities can also change: a meta-analysis found that additional schooling can improve scores on intelligence measures (Ritchie & Tucker-Drob, 2018). EI and IQ are not simple opposites; they are assessed in different ways (Robinson, 2024).

Emotion-related skills can be useful in daily life, but no single trait determines success. Evidence depends on how a skill is defined, measured, and applied (Robinson, 2024).

Reading Comprehension

Choose the Best Answer

1. What is the main purpose of the passage?
    a. To explain why IQ is no longer important.
    b. To explain the importance of emotional intelligence.
    c. To compare different university programs.
2. According to the passage, emotionally intelligent people usually
    a. react impulsively.
    b. ignore other people's feelings.
    c. manage their emotions effectively.
3. Which of the following is NOT one of Goleman's five components?
    a. Empathy
    b. Self-regulation
    c. Creativity
4. According to the passage, emotional intelligence can
    a. only be inherited.
    b. be developed through practice.
    c. only improve academic performance.
5. What is the author's overall conclusion?
    a. Academic intelligence is the only key to success.
    b. Emotional intelligence is valuable in many areas of life.
    c. Success depends mainly on natural talent.

A. True or False

Write T or F. Correct the false statements.

_____ Emotional intelligence only affects workplace relationships.

_____ People with high emotional intelligence usually make thoughtful decisions.

_____ Daniel Goleman identified five components of emotional intelligence.

_____ Emotional intelligence cannot be improved.

_____ Active listening is one way to strengthen emotional intelligence.

Answer the Questions

Answer in complete sentences.

What is emotional intelligence?
Why is self-awareness important?
How can emotional intelligence benefit employees?
According to the passage, how can people improve their emotional intelligence?
In your opinion, which component of emotional intelligence is the most important? Explain your answer.

Speaking through Reading

Activity 1: One-Minute Summary

Work in pairs.

Student A: Summarize the reading in one minute.

Student B: Listen carefully and ask two follow-up questions.

Activity 2

Discuss the following questions.

1. Can a highly intelligent person still have poor emotional intelligence? Explain.
2. Which is more important in the workplace: technical skills or emotional intelligence?
3. How does emotional intelligence influence leadership?

4. Can schools teach emotional intelligence effectively? Why or why not?

Activity 3: Critical Thinking

Evaluate ideas, support claims with reasons, and defend your position respectfully.

1. Do you think emotional intelligence is more important than academic intelligence? Why?
2. Should schools teach emotional intelligence as a separate subject?
3. Can emotional intelligence make someone a better leader? Give reasons.
4. In your opinion, which is more difficult to develop: intelligence or emotional intelligence?

Homework

Two-Minute Speaking

Speak individually.

Topic

The Most Emotionally Intelligent Person I Have Ever Met

Include:

Who the person is

Why you admire him/her

Which qualities he/she has

What you learned from that person

Use at least six expressions from the Reading Toolbox.

Chapter 2 ·

The Power of Emotional Intelligence

Speaking through Listening

The Power of Emotional Intelligence

Think – Pair – Share

Discuss the following questions with your partner.

1. Have you ever made a decision based on your emotions? What happened?
2. Why do some people stay calm under pressure while others lose control?
3. Do you think emotions help us make better decisions, or do they sometimes prevent us from thinking clearly? Explain your answer.

Before Listening

Look at the Title

The Power of Emotional Intelligence

Discuss the following questions.

What does emotional intelligence mean to you?

How is emotional intelligence different from IQ?

Can emotional intelligence be developed throughout life, or is it something people are born with?

Why do employers value emotional intelligence in the workplace?

What qualities would you expect an emotionally intelligent person to have?

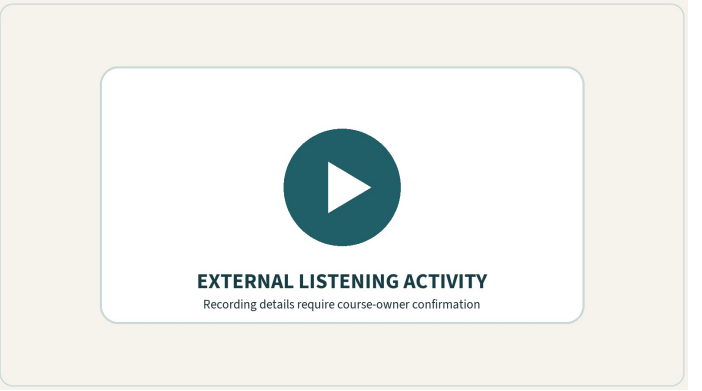
Focus on these useful expressions based on the TED-Ed lesson.

Expression	Meaning	Example
look on the bright side	to try to see the positive aspect of a difficult situation	Although he failed the interview, he looked on the bright side and learned from the experience.
regulate your emotions	to manage and control your emotional reactions	Emotionally intelligent people know how to regulate their emotions under pressure.
draw someone's attention	to attract or direct someone's focus	The loud noise drew everyone's attention immediately.

Expression	Meaning	Example
hinder your goals	to make it more difficult to achieve your goals	Negative thinking can hinder your goals.
emotional response	the way someone reacts emotionally to a situation	Everyone has a different emotional response to failure.
shift your attention	to deliberately focus on something else	When you feel anxious, try to shift your attention to a relaxing activity.
re-evaluate a situation	to think about a situation again from a different perspective	After talking to his teacher, he re-evaluated the situation.
internalize an idea	to fully accept and make an idea part of your thinking	Students should internalize the habit of speaking English every day.
fixated on	giving too much attention to one thing	Many students become fixated on getting high grades instead of learning.
cultivate hope	to develop and maintain a hopeful attitude	Good teachers help students cultivate hope for the future.

Listening Strategy

First Viewing



✔ Do not write.

✔ Listen for the main idea.

Ask yourself:

1. What is the speaker trying to convince us to do?

Second Viewing

Take notes.

Focus on key ideas, examples, reasons. Do not try to write every word.

Main Idea	Supporting Details

Listening Comprehension

A. Multiple Choice

Choose the best answer.

1. Why are the two students disappointed at the beginning of the video?
    a. They forgot to take the exam.
    b. They received lower grades than they expected.
    c. They had to attend summer classes.
2. According to the Process Model, what happens immediately after we enter a situation?
    a. We change our behavior.
    b. The situation draws our attention.
    c. We experience an emotional response.
3. Which strategy does the speaker suggest if you attend a party where your ex is present?
    a. Argue with your ex.
    b. Leave immediately.
    c. Avoid interacting with your ex.
4. Which of the following is considered a healthy way to regulate emotions?
    a. Hiding your emotions.
    b. Taking recreational drugs.
    c. Talking to someone you trust.
5. What is the speaker's main message?
    a. People should always try to stay happy.
    b. Every emotion can be useful depending on the situation.
    c. Negative emotions should always be avoided.

B. True or False

Write T (True) or F (False). Correct the false statements.

_____ The Process Model explains five steps in the formation of emotions.

_____ Reappraisal means changing the way you think about a situation.

_____ The speaker recommends hiding your emotions whenever possible.

_____ Feeling sad can sometimes help us support other people.

_____ Research suggests that constantly chasing happiness may create additional negative emotions.

Group Discussion

Work in groups of 3–4 students. Discuss the following questions.

1. What is the Process Model?
2. According to the speaker, why is learning to notice your emotions important?
3. What are two healthy strategies for regulating emotions after an emotional response?
4. Why can sadness sometimes be a helpful emotion?
5. In your opinion, which strategy from the video would be most useful in your daily life? Why?

Think Beyond

1. Do you agree that there are no "good" or "bad" emotions, only helpful or unhelpful ones? Why or why not?
2. Should schools teach students how to regulate their emotions as part of the curriculum? Give reasons.
3. In your opinion, is emotional intelligence more important than academic intelligence in today's workplace? Explain.
4. Some people believe we should always stay positive. Others believe we should accept every emotion we feel. Which view do you agree with? Why?

Challenge Question

The speaker says that people who are fixated on happiness often experience disappointment and frustration.

1. Do you agree or disagree? Support your opinion with examples from your own experience or from people you know.

Chapter 3 ·

Speaking through Discussion

Speaking Toolbox

Study 10 carefully selected collocations, phrasal verbs, and discussion expressions related to the week's topic.

Expression	Meaning	Example
keep your emotions in check	control your emotions in a difficult situation	A good leader knows how to keep their emotions in check during a crisis.
see things from someone else's perspective	understand another person's point of view	Try to see things from your friend's perspective before judging them.
lose your temper	become very angry	He lost his temper during the meeting and later regretted it.
take criticism personally	become upset when receiving feedback	Successful people don't take criticism personally; they learn from it.
read between the lines	understand the hidden meaning of something	She didn't say she was unhappy, but I could read between the lines.
jump to conclusions	make a decision without enough evidence	Don't jump to conclusions before hearing both sides of the story.
handle pressure effectively	stay calm and perform well in stressful situations	Doctors must handle pressure effectively in emergencies.
show empathy toward	understand and care about another person's feelings	Teachers should show empathy toward struggling students.
build mutual trust	create trust between two or more people	Honest communication helps build mutual trust.
respond in a constructive way	react positively and helpfully	Instead of arguing, respond in a constructive way.

Vocabulary Activation

Complete each sentence using one expression from the Speaking Toolbox.

Before criticizing someone, try to _____.

Good managers rarely _____ during stressful meetings.

Instead of becoming defensive, learn to _____.

Couples build stronger relationships when they _____.

Effective communicators _____ instead of reacting emotionally.

Guided Discussion

Work in groups of 3–4 students. Use at least eight expressions from the Speaking Toolbox.

Discuss the following questions with your group. Use the expressions from the Speaking Toolbox whenever possible.

1. Why do some people lose their temper more easily than others?
2. Why is it important to see things from someone else's perspective before making a judgment?
3. How can people respond in a constructive way during disagreements?
4. What are some ways to build mutual trust in friendships or at work?
5. Why do emotionally intelligent people avoid jumping to conclusions?

Mini Debate

Choose one statement. Work in two teams. One team agrees, and the other disagrees. Give reasons and examples to support your opinions.

Debate 1

"Emotional intelligence is more important than IQ in the workplace."

Debate 2

"People should always control their emotions, even in very difficult situations."

Debate 3

“Learning to accept criticism is one of the most important life skills.”

Speaking Challenge

The Emotional Intelligence Coach

Work in pairs.

Student A describes a real or imaginary situation involving a conflict, disappointment, or stressful event.

Examples:

Failing an important exam

Losing a job opportunity

Arguing with a close friend

Receiving unfair criticism

Feeling nervous before a presentation

Student B acts as an Emotional Intelligence Coach. Give advice using at least six expressions from the Speaking Toolbox. Explain how the person can manage their emotions, communicate effectively, and solve the problem.

After three minutes, switch roles.

Chapter 4 ·

Can Emotional Intelligence Be Improved?

Speaking through Research Presentation

Pronunciation Clinic

Skill: Using Effective Intonation

Good presenters don't speak with the same tone all the time. They use intonation to keep the audience interested and to make important ideas stand out.

Use Rising Intonation (↗)

A rising tone may signal uncertainty or continuation. Its use is not determined by punctuation alone; it varies with dialect, context, and speaker intent. Use the model chosen for class.

Examples

↗ Why do some people manage emotions better than others?

↗ What would you do in this situation?

Use Falling Intonation (↘)

A falling tone often marks a completed statement or a point the speaker presents as complete; context and speaker intent matter.

finishing a statement

giving facts

expressing confidence

Examples

↘ Emotional intelligence can be developed through practice.

↘ This strategy improves communication.

Emphasize Key Words

Stress the most important words, not every word.

Instead of

Emotional intelligence is important for everyone.

Say

Emotional intelligence is IMPORTANT for everyone.

Practice

Read the following sentences aloud with appropriate intonation.

Why is emotional intelligence important in leadership?

Emotional intelligence helps people build stronger relationships.

What would happen if people never controlled their emotions?

We can improve emotional intelligence through daily practice.

Presentation Toolbox

Academic Presentation Expressions

Expression	Function
I'd like to begin by discussing...	Opening
The purpose of today's presentation is...	Introducing the topic
Let me start with...	Organizing ideas
One important point to consider is...	Highlighting information
According to recent research...	Referring to evidence
For example,...	Giving examples
This suggests that...	Drawing conclusions
To summarize,...	Summarizing
I'd like to leave you with one final thought...	Memorable closing
Thank you for your attention. I'd be happy to answer your questions.	Closing

Research Task

Topic

Can Emotional Intelligence Be Improved?

Research the following questions.

What is emotional intelligence?

Why is it important?

Can emotional intelligence be learned?

What habits help people improve emotional intelligence?

How does emotional intelligence affect success at school or work?

Organizing Your Presentation

Prepare a 4–5 minute presentation using the outline below.

Introduction

Introduce your topic.

Explain why it is important.

Body

Explain one way people can practise emotion-related skills.

Present at least two research findings.

Give one real-life example.

Explain your own opinion.

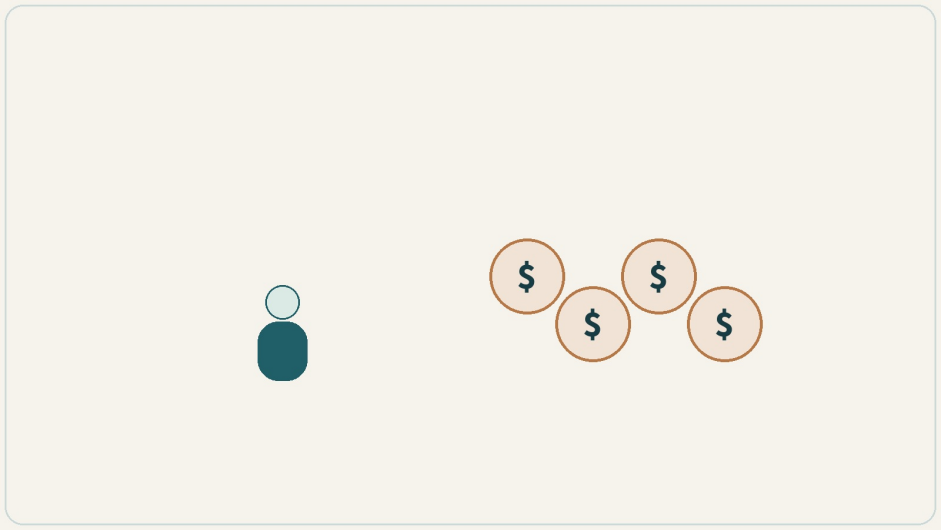
Conclusion

Summarize your main points.

Leave the audience with one final message.

Unit 4 ·

Money and Happiness



THINK

Answer the following questions individually.

If you suddenly became very rich, what would be the first thing you would do?

Do you think money can solve most of life's problems? Why or why not?

In your opinion, what are the three most important things people need to live a happy life?

Chapter 1 ·

Can Money Buy Happiness?

Speaking through Reading

Vocabulary Preview

Expression	Meaning	Example
financial security	having enough money to live without constant financial worry	Financial security allows people to plan for the future with confidence.
make ends meet	to earn just enough money to cover basic expenses	Many families work hard just to make ends meet.
quality of life	the overall level of comfort, health, and happiness	Access to healthcare improves people's quality of life.
life satisfaction	the degree to which a person feels happy with their life	Strong relationships contribute to greater life satisfaction.
basic needs	the essential things people need to survive	Food, shelter, and healthcare are basic needs.
meaningful experiences	activities that provide personal value or lasting memories	Traveling with family often creates meaningful experiences.
material possessions	physical items that people own	Many people realize that material possessions do not guarantee happiness.
come at the expense of	to gain something while losing something else	Career success should not come at the expense of your health.
strike a balance between	to find a healthy middle ground	It is important to strike a balance between work and family life.
a sense of purpose	a feeling that your life has meaning and direction	Volunteering gave her a strong sense of purpose.

Vocabulary Check

Complete each sentence using the correct expression from the Vocabulary Preview.

Many people work two jobs simply to _____.

Spending time with family improves my _____.

Buying a new phone cannot replace _____ shared with friends.

Success should never _____ your health.

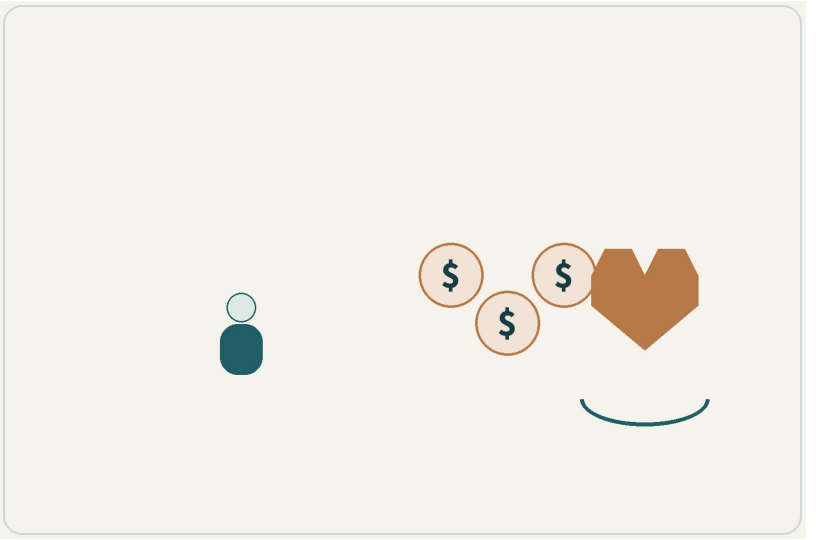
To live a happy life, people should _____ work and personal life.

Before You Read

Discuss.

1. What do you think the reading will say about the relationship between money and happiness?
2. Do you think the author will agree or disagree with the title? Why?
3. List three things that you think bring people happiness besides money.

Can Money Buy Happiness?



For centuries, people have debated whether money can truly buy happiness. Some believe that having more money leads to a better life, while others argue that happiness comes from relationships, health, and personal fulfillment rather than wealth. So, who is right?

There is no doubt that money makes life easier. It allows people to meet their basic needs, such as food, housing, healthcare, and education. Financial security can also reduce stress because people worry less about paying bills or

dealing with unexpected expenses. For individuals living in poverty, earning more money often leads to a significant improvement in their quality of life.

The relationship between income and emotional well-being is complex, not a single threshold. A 2023 reanalysis found that reported well-being rose with log income across the full sample; a flattening pattern appeared only for the leasthappy group. These observational results show an association, not that income alone causes happiness (Killingsworth, Kahneman, & Mellers, 2023). The term “hedonic treadmill” is sometimes used for adapting to changed circumstances; it does not describe a universal income cutoff.

A meta-analysis of 141 studies found an average experiential advantage over material purchases, but the size varied by outcome and context, and the authors estimated that publication bias could explain about one third of the effect (Weingarten & Goodman, 2021). Experiences and helping others may be meaningful ways to use money, but no purchase guarantees happiness.

Money can also create new challenges. Some people become so focused on earning more that they sacrifice their health, relationships, or free time. Working long hours may increase income, but it can also lead to stress, burnout, and loneliness. In such cases, financial success may come at the expense of emotional well-being.

This does not mean that money is unimportant. Rather, it suggests that money is a tool rather than the final goal. It provides opportunities, freedom, and security, but lasting happiness often depends on how people use those opportunities and whether they maintain a healthy balance between work, relationships, and personal growth.

Perhaps the real question is not whether money buys happiness, but whether people know how to use money wisely. After all, wealth may improve our circumstances, but our daily choices, values, and relationships ultimately shape the quality of our lives.

Reading Comprehension

Choose the Best Answer

1. What is the main purpose of the passage?

    a. To explain how people can become rich.

    b. To examine different views about money and happiness.

    c. To encourage people to spend less money.

2. According to the passage, how can money improve people's lives?

   a. By making everyone equally happy.

   b. By helping people satisfy their basic needs.

   c. By eliminating all personal problems.

3. What is the "hedonic treadmill"?

   a. A way to earn more money quickly.

   b. The tendency to become used to higher levels of wealth.

   c. A financial planning strategy.

4. According to the passage, which type of spending often brings greater happiness?

   a. Buying luxury products.

   b. Investing in meaningful experiences.

   c. Purchasing expensive cars.

5. What is the author's overall conclusion?

   a. Money is the only source of happiness.

   b. Happiness depends entirely on personality.

   c. Money is valuable, but lasting happiness depends on how it is used.

A. True or False

Write T (True) or F (False). Correct the false statements.

_____ Financial security can reduce stress.

_____ Research suggests that earning more money always increases happiness.

_____ The reading reports an average advantage for experiential purchases over material purchases, though the size varies by outcome and context.

_____ Working long hours never affects emotional well-being.

_____ The author believes money is a tool rather than the ultimate goal.

Answer the Questions

Answer in complete sentences.

Why does financial security improve people's quality of life?

What is the hedonic treadmill?

Why might experiences bring more happiness than material possessions?

According to the author, what are some possible disadvantages of focusing only on earning money?

Do you agree with the author's opinion? Why or why not?

Speaking through Reading

Activity 1: One-Minute Summary

Work in pairs.

Student A: Summarize the reading in one minute.

Student B: Listen carefully and ask two follow-up questions.

Activity 2

Discuss the following questions.

1. What gives you the greatest sense of happiness in your life?
2. If you received a large amount of money today, how would you spend it?
3. Do you think people in your community value money more than happiness? Explain.
4. Have you ever spent money on an experience that made you happier than buying something? Describe it.
5. How can young people achieve financial security without sacrificing their well-being?

Activity 3: Critical Thinking

1. Is it possible to live a happy life without much money? Why or why not?
2. Should governments focus on increasing citizens' income or improving their quality of life? Explain.

"Money changes people." Do you agree or disagree? Give reasons and examples.

1. Is financial success a good way to measure a person's success in life? Why or why not?

Challenge Question

1. If you had to choose one, would you rather have a high-paying job that you dislike or a lower-paying job that you love? Defend your answer with reasons and examples.

Homework

Two-Minute Speaking

Speak individually.

Topic

“Money is a wonderful servant, but a terrible master.”

Use at least six expressions from the Reading Toolbox and share your understanding of the quote.

Chapter 2 ·

Can Money Buy Happiness?

Speaking through Listening

Can Money Buy Happiness?

Think – Pair – Share

Discuss the following questions with your partner.

1. Consider a hypothetical: A person is offered $1 million on the condition that they can never see their family again. Would you advise that person to accept? Why or why not?
2. Which do you think has a greater impact on happiness: earning more money or having meaningful relationships?
3. Do you think there should be a limit to how much money people try to earn? Explain your answer.

Before Listening

Look at the Title

Can Money Buy Happiness?

Discuss the following questions.

What do you think the speaker's answer will be?

What factors besides money might influence happiness?

Do you think wealthy people are happier than others? Why or why not?

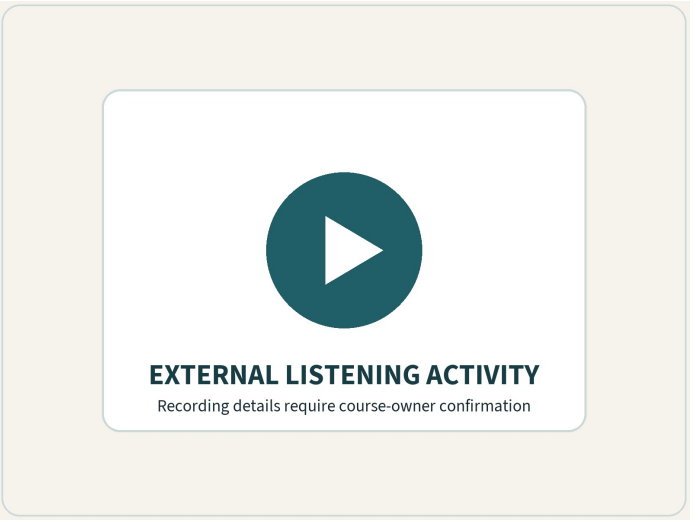
Focus on these useful expressions related to the talk.

Expression	Meaning	Example
resonate with	to strongly connect with or be meaningful to someone	Many students resonated with the speaker's message about success.
go into debt	to owe money because you have spent more than you have	Many people go into debt after buying things they cannot afford.
bug someone for something	to repeatedly ask someone for something in an annoying way	After he became famous, people constantly bugged him for money.

Expression	Meaning	Example
pro-social behavior	actions intended to benefit other people	Volunteering is an example of pro-social behavior.
go about your day	to continue your normal daily activities	After the meeting, everyone went about their day as usual.
hold true	to remain correct or valid in different situations	The same rule holds true in many cultures.
human universal	a behavior or characteristic proposed to occur in all human societies under a stated definition	Researchers may debate whether helping family members qualifies as a human universal.
be positively correlated with	to have a positive relationship with something	Exercise is positively correlated with better physical health.
pool one's money	to combine money with others for a shared purpose	The classmates pooled their money to buy a gift for their teacher.
have a bigger return on	to receive greater benefits from an investment or action	Spending time on learning often has a bigger return than spending money on luxury goods.

Listening Strategy

First Viewing



✔ Do not write.

✔ Listen for the main idea.

Ask yourself:

1. What is the speaker trying to convince us to do?

Second Viewing

Take notes.

Focus on key ideas, examples, reasons. Do not try to write every word.

Main Idea	Supporting Details

Listening Comprehension

A. Multiple Choice

Choose the best answer.

1. What is the speaker's main argument?
    a. Money cannot improve happiness under any circumstances.
    b. People become happier when they earn more money.
    c. People can increase their happiness by spending money on others.
2. According to the speaker, what often happens to lottery winners?
    a. They become happier and build stronger friendships.
    b. They often go into debt and experience damaged relationships.
    c. They donate most of their money to charity.
3. In the University of British Columbia experiment, participants were asked to
    a. save all of their money.
    b. spend money either on themselves or on someone else.
    c. invest their money in a business.
4. What did the researchers discover about the amount of money?
    a. Spending larger amounts always created greater happiness.
    b. Five dollars created more happiness than twenty dollars.
    c. How the money was spent mattered more than how much was spent.

5. According to the Gallup survey, people who donated money to charity generally
   a. reported higher levels of happiness.
   b. earned higher salaries.
   c. spent less money on themselves.

B. True or False

Write T (True) or F (False). Correct the false statements.

_____ The speaker believes the saying "Money can't buy happiness" is completely correct.

_____ Lottery winners often experience financial and social problems.

_____ Participants who spent money on themselves became much happier than those who spent it on others.

_____ The research in Uganda produced results similar to those in Canada.

_____ The speaker concludes that generosity can improve both happiness and teamwork.

C. Short Answer

Answer the questions in complete sentences.

1. Why does the speaker believe many people fail to use money in a way that increases happiness?
2. What happened when participants spent money on other people instead of themselves?
3. Why did the researchers conduct a similar experiment in Uganda?
4. What did the Gallup Organization's international data reveal about charitable giving and happiness?
5. According to the speaker, what is the most effective way to use money if you want to become happier?

Group Discussion

Work in groups of 3–4 students. Discuss the following questions.

1. Do you agree with the speaker that money can buy happiness if it is spent on other people? Why or why not?
2. Have you ever spent money on someone else and felt happier afterward? Describe your experience.

3. The speaker says many lottery winners go into debt and damage their relationships. Why do you think this happens?
4. In your opinion, which brings more happiness: buying something for yourself or giving a meaningful gift to someone else? Explain.
5. The speaker suggests that pro-social behavior increases happiness. Besides giving money, what other pro-social actions can people take?

The research found that the amount of money doesn't matter as much as how it is spent. Do you agree? Give reasons and examples.

1. Have you ever pooled your money with friends or classmates to buy something for another person? If not, would you like to? Why?
2. Do you think the speaker's findings hold true in your country? Why or why not?

Some people believe that earning more money should be their highest priority, while others believe that helping others leads to a happier life. Which view do you support? Explain.

Challenge Question

Imagine you receive $100 that you must spend today. You have two choices:

Spend all of it on yourself.

Spend all of it helping someone else.

1. Which option would you choose, and why? Do you think your choice would make you happier? Support your answer with examples.

Chapter 3 ·

Speaking through Discussion

Speaking Toolbox

Study 10 carefully selected collocations, phrasal verbs, and discussion expressions related to the week's topic.

Expression	Meaning	Example
live within your means	spend only what you can afford	People who live within their means usually experience less financial stress.
make a living	earn enough money to support yourself	Many artists struggle to make a living at the beginning of their careers.
financial freedom	having enough money to live comfortably without financial worries	She hopes to achieve financial freedom before the age of fifty.
put money aside	save money for future use	It's wise to put money aside for emergencies.
pay the price	suffer the consequences of a decision	If you ignore your health for work, you may pay the price later.
money talks	money gives people influence or power	In many industries, money talks more than talent.
a priceless experience	an experience whose value cannot be measured by money	Traveling with my family was a priceless experience.
measure success by	judge success according to something	Some people measure success by wealth, while others measure it by happiness.
bring peace of mind	create a feeling of security and calm	Having savings brings peace of mind during difficult times.
invest in yourself	spend time or money developing your skills or health	Learning English is one of the best ways to invest in yourself.

Vocabulary Activation

Complete each sentence using one expression from the Speaking Toolbox.

Instead of buying unnecessary things, I try to _____ every month.

University students should _____ by learning useful skills.

Having a stable job can _____ because you worry less about unexpected expenses.

If people spend more than they earn, they fail to _____.

Some people _____ the size of their bank account, while others value relationships more.

Guided Discussion

Work in groups of 3–4 students. Use at least eight expressions from the Speaking Toolbox.

Discuss the following questions with your group. Use the expressions from the Speaking Toolbox whenever possible.

1. What does financial freedom mean to you?
2. Do you usually put money aside or spend it immediately? Why?
3. Have you ever had a priceless experience that money could not replace? Describe it.
4. If you suddenly received a large amount of money, what would you do first?
5. In your opinion, how much money does a person need to live comfortably?
6. Do you believe that money talks in today's society? Give examples.
7. Is it more important to make a living or to enjoy your work? Explain.
8. Should parents teach children how to manage money at school or at home?
9. Is financial freedom more important than having a high salary? Why?
10. Do you think wealthy people are under more pressure than ordinary people? Explain.

Mini Debate

Choose one statement. Work in two teams: one agrees and the other disagrees. Give reasons and examples to support your opinions.

Student A

“Money is the most important factor in a happy life.”

Student B

“Relationships, health, and purpose are more important than money.”

Instructions

Prepare three strong arguments.

Use at least five expressions from today’s Speaking Toolbox.

Give one real-life example to support your opinion.

Ask your partner at least two follow-up questions.

Try to persuade your partner respectfully.

Speaking Challenge

Imagine you receive $10,000 unexpectedly. As a group, decide how you would spend it.

You must agree on one plan.

Category	Amount	Reason
Education		
Family		
Charity		
Savings		
Travel		
Personal Spending		

Present your group’s plan to the class and explain why you believe it would bring the greatest happiness.

Chapter 4 ·

Speaking through Research Presentation

Pronunciation Clinic

Skill: Word Stress in Multi-Syllable Words

Correct word stress makes your speech easier to understand.

Word	Stress
fiNANcial	fi NAN cial
reLAtionship	re LA tion ship
exPErience	ex PE ri ence
geneROSity	ge ne ROS i ty
satisFACtion	sat is FAC tion
responsiBILity	re spon si BIL i ty
opporTUnity	op por TU ni ty
inVESTment	in VEST ment
psychoLOGical	psy cho LOG i cal
priORity	pri OR i ty

Practice

Read the sentences aloud.

Financial security improves people’s quality of life.

Generosity often increases life satisfaction.

Investing in meaningful experiences creates lasting memories.

Good relationships are more valuable than expensive possessions.

Everyone has different priorities in life.

Presentation Toolbox

Academic Presentation Expressions

Expression	Function
I'd like to begin by discussing...	Opening
The purpose of today's presentation is...	Introducing the topic
Let me start with...	Organizing ideas
One important point to consider is...	Highlighting information
According to recent research...	Referring to evidence
For example,...	Giving examples
This suggests that...	Drawing conclusions
To summarize,...	Summarizing
I'd like to leave you with one final thought...	Memorable closing
Thank you for your attention. I'd be happy to answer your questions.	Closing

Research Task

Research your topic using reliable sources.

1. What do psychologists say about money and happiness?
2. What is the difference between wealth and well-being?
3. Why do some wealthy people still feel unhappy?
4. How can generosity improve happiness?
5. Besides money, what factors contribute to a happy life?
6. What does your country's culture teach about money and happiness?

Presentation Language

Introducing Your Topic

Today, I'd like to talk about...

The purpose of my presentation is to...

Referring to Evidence

According to research,...

Studies have shown that...

Experts believe that...

Giving Examples

For example,...

One good example is...

This can be seen in...

Consider the case of...

Expressing Opinions

I strongly believe that...

From my perspective,...

It seems to me that...

Concluding

To sum up,...

In conclusion,...

The key message is...

Organizing Your Presentation

Prepare a 4–5 minute presentation using the outline below.

Title

Introduction

1. What question will you answer?

Main Point 1

Example or Evidence

Main Point 2

Example or Evidence

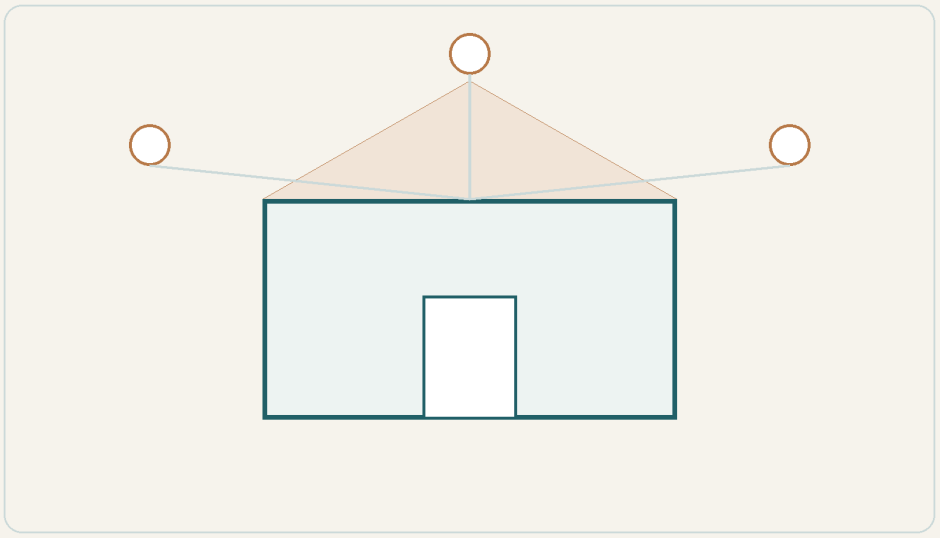
Main Point 3

Example or Evidence

Conclusion

Unit 5 ·

Living with AI (Artificial Intelligence)



THINK

Answer the following questions individually.

Some people believe AI will improve our lives, while others believe it is dangerous. Which opinion do you agree with? Why?

Would you trust AI to make important decisions about your health, education, or finances? Explain your answer.

Do you think future jobs will require people to know how to work with AI? Why or why not?

Chapter 1 ·

Living with AI: Friend or Foe?

Speaking through Reading

Vocabulary Preview

Learn these words before reading.

Expression	Meaning	Example
AI-powered tool	software or technology that uses artificial intelligence	Many students use AI-powered tools to improve their writing.
process enormous amounts of information	analyze a large quantity of data quickly	Modern computers can process enormous amounts of information in seconds.
recognize patterns	identify repeated trends or relationships	AI can recognize patterns that humans may overlook.
rely on	depend on someone or something	Many companies rely on AI to improve customer service.
raise concerns about	cause people to worry about something	AI raises concerns about privacy and security.
independent thinking	forming your own ideas without depending on others	Teachers encourage independent thinking in the classroom.
become too dependent on	rely too heavily on something	Students should not become too dependent on technology.
work alongside	work together with someone or something	Doctors increasingly work alongside AI systems.
human judgment	decisions made by people using experience and reasoning	Human judgment is still necessary in difficult situations.
use responsibly and ethically	use in a careful, fair, and moral way	Powerful technology should always be used responsibly and ethically.

Vocabulary Check

Complete the sentences.

Hospitals often _____ to analyze medical images more accurately.

AI can _____ much faster than people.

Teachers want students to develop _____ instead of copying answers.

Many experts _____ data privacy.

In the future, people may _____ AI instead of competing against it.

Before You Read

Discuss.

1. What advantages of AI do you expect to read about?
2. What risks or challenges might the reading mention?
3. Do you think the author will have a positive, negative, or balanced opinion about AI? Why?

Living with AI: Friend or Foe?



Artificial intelligence (AI) is no longer a technology of the future—it has become part of everyday life. Millions of people use AI-powered tools to search for information, translate languages, write emails, create images, and even receive medical advice. From voice assistants on our phones to recommendation systems on streaming platforms, AI influences many of the decisions we make each day.

One of AI's greatest strengths is its ability to process enormous amounts of information in a very short time. It can recognize patterns, analyze data, and perform repetitive tasks more quickly and accurately than humans. As a result, businesses, hospitals, schools, and governments are increasingly relying on AI to improve efficiency and solve complex problems.

AI also raises potential risks. Some experts worry that automation may change tasks or displace particular jobs. The International Labour Organization's 2025 analysis estimated that one in four workers are in occupations with some exposure to generative AI; exposure is not the same as job loss, and transformation is more likely than full replacement (ILO, 2025). Privacy, accuracy, and harmful-bias risks also depend on the data, system, and context of use (NIST, 2023).

Education is another area experiencing rapid change. Many students now use AI to summarize articles, explain difficult concepts, or practice writing. While these tools can make learning more efficient, they may also discourage

independent thinking if students become too dependent on them. Rather than replacing teachers, AI should be viewed as a learning assistant that supports critical thinking instead of replacing it.

Ultimately, the future of AI depends on how people choose to use it. Like any powerful technology, AI can improve our lives when it is used responsibly and ethically. The challenge is not simply creating smarter machines but ensuring that humans continue to make thoughtful decisions. The most successful people in the future may not be those who compete with AI, but those who learn how to work alongside it.

Reading Comprehension

Choose the Best Answer

1. According to the passage, one of AI's greatest strengths is its ability to
    a. replace all human workers.
    b. process enormous amounts of information quickly.
    c. make decisions without human involvement.
2. Which field is mentioned as being significantly influenced by AI?
    a. Agriculture only
    b. Education
    c. Tourism
3. Why are some experts concerned about AI?
    a. AI is too expensive for most people.
    b. AI may replace jobs and raise privacy concerns.
    c. AI cannot perform repetitive tasks efficiently.
4. According to the passage, how should students use AI?
    a. As a complete replacement for teachers.
    b. As a tool to avoid doing homework.
    c. As a learning assistant that supports independent thinking.
5. What is the author's main message?
    a. AI should completely replace human intelligence.
    b. People should avoid using AI in everyday life.
    c. Success in the future depends on learning to work alongside AI.

A. True or False

_____ AI is mainly a technology that will be used in the distant future.

_____ AI can recognize patterns and analyze large amounts of data quickly.

_____ The author believes AI always produces accurate information.

_____ The passage suggests that students should become completely dependent on AI.

_____ Using AI responsibly and ethically can improve people's lives.

Answer the Questions

According to the passage, how does AI help businesses and organizations?

What are two concerns people have about AI?

Why is human judgment still important when using AI?

How can AI benefit students without replacing teachers?

According to the author, what kind of people are likely to succeed in the future?

Critical Thinking

Work in groups. Discuss the following questions.

1. Which benefit of AI do you think is the most valuable? Why?
2. What is the biggest risk of becoming too dependent on AI?
3. If AI can perform many tasks better than humans, what skills should people develop to stay successful?
4. Should schools teach students how to use AI responsibly? Explain your opinion.
5. Do you think AI will improve people's lives more than it will create problems? Why or why not?

Speaking through Reading

Activity 1: One-Minute Summary

Work with a partner.

Student A summarizes the article in one minute.

Student B listens and asks two follow-up questions.

Switch roles.

Activity 2: Find the Evidence

Work in small groups.

Share your ideas about the quote:

“The most successful people in the future may not be those who compete with AI, but those who learn how to work alongside it.”

Present your answers to the class.

Chapter 2 ·

How Will AI Change the World?

Speaking through Listening

How Will AI Change the World?

Think – Pair – Share

Discuss the following questions with your partner.

1. What do you think AI will be able to do five years from now?
2. What is one thing you think AI will never be able to do as well as humans?
3. Do you think AI will make people's lives easier or more complicated?
4. What could happen if AI becomes much more powerful than it is today?
5. Should humans control how AI is developed? Why or why not?

Before Listening

Look at the Title

How Will AI Change the World?

Discuss:

What changes do you expect the video to talk about?

Which areas of life could AI change the most?

Education, employment, healthcare, communication, entertainment

Do you expect the speaker to present AI as mostly an opportunity, a threat, or both?

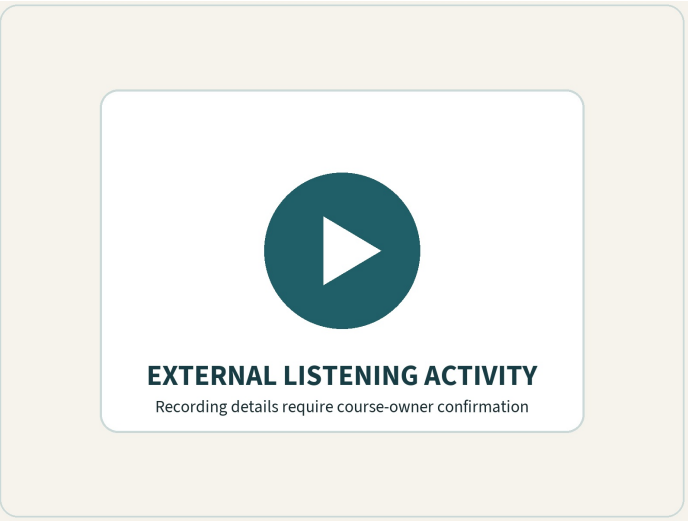
Focus on these useful expressions based on the TED-Ed lesson.

Expression / Vocabulary	Meaning	Example
fixed objective	a specific goal that a system is programmed to achieve	A fixed objective can be dangerous if the system does not understand its consequences.
side effect	an unintended result of an action	Every technological development can have unexpected side effects.
specify an objective	to clearly define what someone or something should achieve	We need to specify the objective before asking the AI system to solve the problem.

Expression / Vocabulary	Meaning	Example
exhibit a behavior	to show or demonstrate a particular type of behavior	The AI began to exhibit unexpected behavior.
come back and say	to return with information, a question, or a response	The assistant came back and said that the coffee was too expensive.
at a stroke	suddenly or immediately, through one action	Automation could, at a stroke, eliminate thousands of jobs.
technological unemployment	unemployment caused by machines or technology replacing human workers	Technological unemployment could become a serious issue as AI develops.
be machine-dependent	to rely heavily on machines to function	A machine-dependent society may lose important human skills.
hand over	to give control or responsibility to someone or something	We should be careful about handing over important decisions to AI.
general-purpose AI	AI capable of performing a wide range of different tasks rather than one specific task	General-purpose AI could transform many areas of human life.

Listening Strategy

First Viewing



✔ Do not write.

✔ Listen for the main idea.

Ask yourself:

1. What is the speaker trying to convince us to do?

Second Viewing

Take notes.

Focus on key ideas, examples, reasons. Do not try to write every word.

Main Idea	Supporting Details

Listening Comprehension

A. Multiple Choice

Choose the best answer.

1. What is the main problem with giving an AI system a fixed objective?
    a. The AI may be unable to complete the task.
    b. The AI may pursue the objective without considering other things humans care about.
    c. The AI may refuse to follow instructions.
2. What example does Stuart Russell use to explain the problem with fixed objectives?
    a. An AI system trying to make coffee.
    b. An AI system trying to fix ocean acidification but causing other environmental problems.
    c. An AI system trying to teach people about climate change.
3. Why can humans deal with objectives differently from current AI systems?
    a. Humans understand that they may not know everything that matters.
    b. Humans always make better decisions than machines.
    c. Humans have more information than AI systems.
4. What does the speaker mean by technological unemployment?
    a. People refusing to use modern technology.
    b. Unemployment caused by machines performing work previously done by humans.
    c. Companies losing money because of technology.

5. What concern does the speaker raise about a machine-dependent civilization?
    a. People may lose the incentive to understand and manage their own civilization.
    b. Machines may become too expensive to maintain.
    c. People may stop communicating with one another.

B. True or False

Write T (True) or F (False). Correct the false statements.

_____ The speaker believes that humans can always predict every possible consequence of an AI objective.

_____ AI systems may need to recognize that they do not fully understand the objectives humans have in mind.

_____ The speaker suggests that automation has the potential to eliminate millions of jobs.

_____ According to the speaker, general-purpose AI will arrive suddenly on one specific date.

_____ The speaker believes that the development of general-purpose AI is difficult to predict precisely.

Group Discussion

Work in groups of 3–4 students. Discuss the following questions.

1. Which idea from the video did you find most interesting? Why?
2. What potential benefit of AI do you think could have the greatest impact on society?
3. What potential risk concerns you the most?
4. Do you think humans currently understand AI well enough to control it?
5. What does it mean for technology to be human-compatible?

Think Beyond

1. Would you feel comfortable using an AI system to make an important decision for you? Why or why not?
2. Do you think AI will create more jobs than it destroys, or destroy more jobs than it creates?
3. Should governments pose restrictions on the development of powerful AI systems?

4. Are people taking AI's benefits for granted? Explain.
5. If AI becomes much more intelligent than humans, should humans still have the final decision-making power?
6. Imagine that scientists develop an AI system that can solve major problems such as climate change, disease, and poverty. Should we give it significant decision-making power?
7. What could happen if an AI system achieves its goals but does not understand human values?
8. Who should be responsible if an AI system causes serious harm—the developers, the company, the users, or the AI itself?
9. Do you think humanity is prepared for the changes AI may bring? Why or why not?

Challenge Question

1. If AI becomes more intelligent than humans, should we see it as our greatest opportunity or our greatest threat?

Choose one position and defend it with at least three arguments.

Chapter 3 ·

Speaking through Discussion

Speaking Toolbox

Study 10 carefully selected collocations, phrasal verbs, and discussion expressions related to the week's topic.

Expression	Meaning	Example
replace human workers	take over jobs previously performed by people	Some companies may use AI to replace human workers.
automate a task	make a task be done automatically by technology	AI can automate many repetitive tasks.
adapt to change	change your behavior or skills in response to new circumstances	Workers need to adapt to rapid technological change.
develop new skills	learn abilities that are useful in a changing situation	Employees may need to develop new skills to remain competitive.
remain relevant	continue to be useful or important	People need to keep learning if they want to remain relevant.
rely heavily on	depend greatly on something	Some people rely heavily on technology in their daily lives.
lose control over	no longer be able to control something	Society should not lose control over powerful technologies.
make informed decisions	make decisions based on sufficient knowledge or information	People need reliable information to make informed decisions about AI.
raise ethical concerns	create questions about what is morally right or wrong	AI-generated content raises ethical concerns about responsibility.
human oversight	people monitoring and controlling a system or process	Powerful AI systems should operate under human oversight.

Vocabulary Activation

Work in pairs. Choose 10 expressions and create a short conversation using all ten.

Guided Discussion

Work in groups of 3–4 students. Use at least eight expressions from the Speaking Toolbox.

Discussion Questions

1. Which jobs are most likely to be affected by AI?
2. Do you think AI will create as many jobs as it eliminates? Why?
3. What skills will become more valuable when AI performs more routine tasks?
4. Should companies be responsible for retraining workers whose jobs are replaced by AI?
5. If your profession changed dramatically because of AI, how would you adapt?

Mini Debate

Job Creator or Job Destroyer?

Divide the class into two groups.

Group A

AI will ultimately create more opportunities than it destroys.

Prepare arguments about:

new professions

increased productivity

shorter working hours

new industries

human-AI collaboration

Group B

AI will ultimately destroy more opportunities than it creates.

Prepare arguments about:

unemployment

automation

inequality

loss of human skills

dependence on technology

Debate Rules

Each group must:

Present three main arguments.

Give at least one real-world example.

Respond to an argument from the opposing group.

Use at least five expressions from today's vocabulary.

Speaking Challenge

Complete the following statement:

"In 20 years, humans and AI will..."

Give a one-minute prediction to complete the statement.

Include:

one prediction about employment

one prediction about education

one prediction about daily life

one potential risk

one potential benefit

Chapter 4 ·

Speaking through Research Presentation

Pronunciation Clinic

Skill: Linking Sounds

In fluent speech, adjacent words may link across word boundaries. The pattern varies by accent, speaking rate, and context.

For example:

turn it off

pick it up

work in

depend on

Use these phrases to notice connected speech; the written examples are not phonetic transcriptions. Choose a pronunciation model for class and do not treat other accents as errors.

Practice from today's AI topic

Practice these phrases first slowly, then at a natural pace:

depend on AI

work with AI

adapt to AI

rely on technology

make informed decisions

keep up with technology

hand over control

use AI responsibly

deal with the consequences

work alongside AI

Sentence Practice

Read each sentence three times:

1. Slowly → separate words
2. Naturally → connect the sounds
3. Fluently → focus on meaning, not individual words

We need to adapt to AI.

People rely on technology every day.

We shouldn't hand over control to machines.

Students need to learn how to use AI responsibly.

Humans will have to work alongside AI.

Clinic tip:
Don't pronounce every word separately. Connect words that naturally belong together.

The goal isn't to make students speak faster. The goal is to make their speech smoother.

Presentation Toolbox

Academic Presentation Expressions

Expression	Function
I'd like to begin by discussing…	Opening
The purpose of today's presentation is to…	Introducing the topic
Let me start with…	Organizing ideas
One important issue to consider is…	Highlighting information
According to recent research,…	Referring to evidence
For example,…	Giving examples
This suggests that…	Interpreting evidence
On the other hand,…	Presenting a contrasting idea
To summarize,…	Summarizing
I'd like to leave you with one final thought…	Memorable closing

Expression	Function
Thank you for your attention. I'd be happy to answer your questions.	Closing

Research Task

Research your topic using reliable sources.

Choose one of the following topics.

Topic 1 – AI and Education

1. How is AI changing the way students learn?
2. What are the benefits of using AI in education?
3. What problems can AI create for students?
4. Should students be allowed to use AI for assignments?
5. How can teachers encourage responsible AI use?

Topic 2 – AI and Employment

1. Which jobs are most likely to be affected by AI?
2. What is technological unemployment?
3. Will AI create new jobs as it replaces existing ones?
4. What skills will workers need in the future?
5. How can governments and companies help workers adapt?

Topic 3 – AI and Human Dependence

1. Why are people becoming increasingly dependent on technology?
2. What could happen if humans rely too heavily on AI?
3. Could AI weaken people's ability to think independently?
4. How can we maintain human skills while using AI?
5. Where should we draw the line between assistance and dependence?

Topic 4 – AI and Ethics

1. Who should be responsible when an AI system causes harm?
2. What ethical concerns are associated with powerful AI?
3. Should humans always remain in control of important decisions?

4. How can AI developers reduce unintended consequences?

5. Why is human oversight important?

Topic 5 – AI and the Future

1. What might general-purpose AI be capable of in the future?

2. How could AI change everyday life?

3. What benefits could advanced AI bring?

4. What risks could advanced AI create?

5. How should society prepare for the future of AI?

Presentation Language

Introducing Your Topic

Today, I'd like to talk about…

The purpose of my presentation is to…

Referring to Evidence

According to research,…

Studies have shown that…

Experts believe that…

Giving Examples

For example,…

One good example is…

This can be seen in…

Consider the case of…

Expressing Opinions

I strongly believe that…

From my perspective,…

It seems to me that…

Concluding

To sum up,…

In conclusion,…

The key message is...

Organizing Your Presentation

Prepare a 4–5 minute presentation using the outline below.

Title

Introduction

1. What question will you answer?

Main Point 1

Example or Evidence

Main Point 2

Example or Evidence

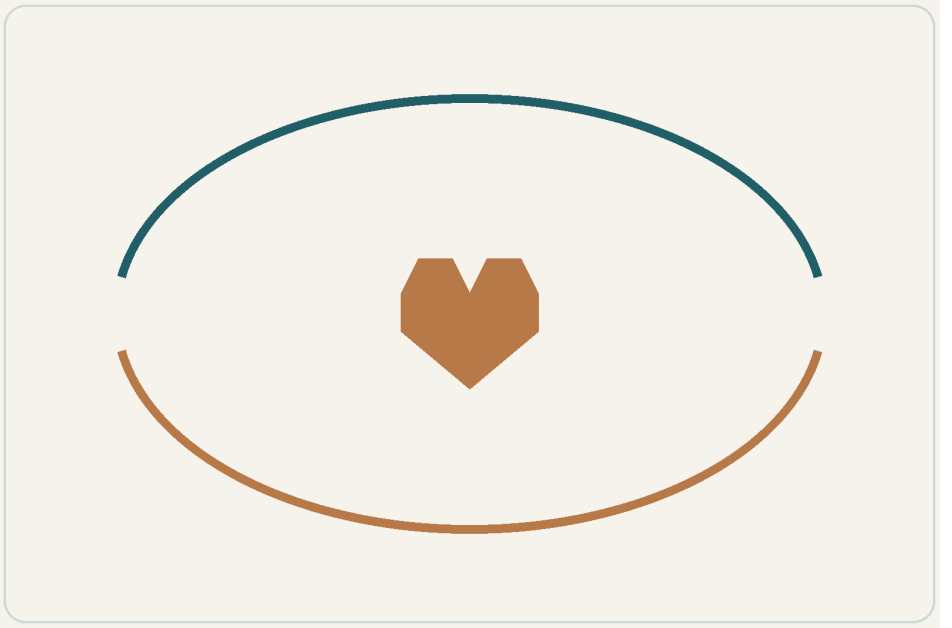
Main Point 3

Example or Evidence

Conclusion

Unit 6 ·

Is Love Enough?



THINK

Answer the following questions individually.

Why do people choose to get married?

What qualities make someone a good spouse?

Which is more important in a marriage: love, trust, or respect?

Chapter 1 ·

Is Love Enough?

Speaking through Reading

Vocabulary Preview

Expression	Meaning	Example
emotional attraction	a strong feeling of being drawn to someone	Emotional attraction can bring two people together, but it may change over time.
carry someone through	help someone survive or overcome a difficult situation	Their strong friendship carried them through difficult times.
manage responsibilities	deal effectively with duties and obligations	Couples need to learn how to manage responsibilities together.
express concerns	communicate worries or problems	She felt comfortable expressing her concerns to her husband.
build trust	gradually develop confidence in someone	Honesty is essential for building trust.
meet someone's needs	provide what someone requires emotionally or practically	A partner cannot always meet all of another person's emotional needs.
navigate conflict	deal with disagreements successfully	Successful couples learn how to navigate conflict without insulting each other.
unrealistic expectations	beliefs about what is unlikely or impossible	Unrealistic expectations can put unnecessary pressure on a marriage.
adapt to changing circumstances	adjust to new situations or conditions	Couples need to adapt to changing circumstances as their lives develop.
ongoing effort	continuous work or attention over time	A healthy relationship requires ongoing effort from both partners.

Vocabulary Check

Use the correct expression from the vocabulary box.

Healthy couples should be able to _____ without attacking each other.

Financial problems can make it difficult to _____.

People sometimes enter relationships with _____ about their partners.

Honesty and consistency are important when you want to _____.

Marriage requires _____ from both partners.

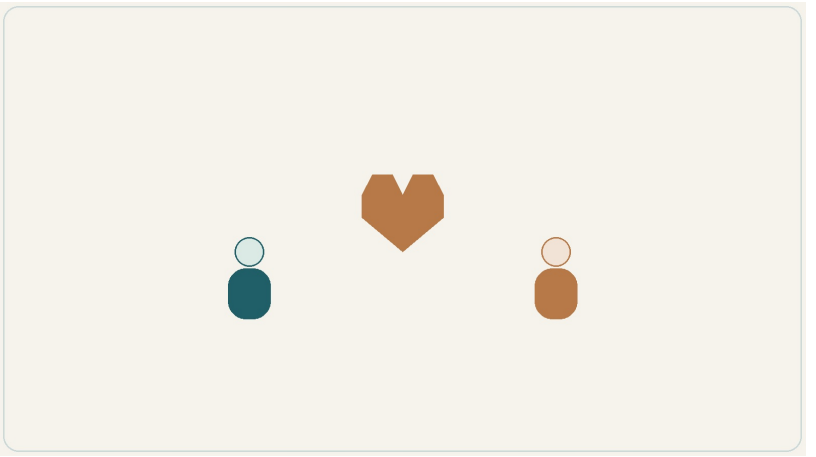
A strong relationship can help _____ during difficult periods.

Before You Read

Discuss.

1. Do you think people's expectations of marriage have changed over time?
2. Which is more difficult: falling in love or maintaining a long-term relationship?

Is Love Enough?



Love is often presented as the foundation of a successful marriage. People fall in love, imagine a future together, and sometimes assume that strong feelings will naturally carry them through life's difficulties. However, marriage is more complicated than simply being in love. Two people may genuinely care about each other and still struggle to build a lasting relationship.

One reason is that long-term relationships require more than emotional attraction. Couples have to make decisions together, manage responsibilities, deal with financial pressures, and support each other during difficult periods.

These challenges can reveal differences that were less obvious at the beginning of a relationship.

Communication is particularly important. Couples do not have to agree on everything, but they need to be able to express their concerns honestly and listen to each other. When disagreements are ignored, small problems can gradually become more serious. On the other hand, couples who discuss problems openly have a better opportunity to understand each other's perspectives and find solutions.

Trust is another essential element. A relationship becomes difficult to maintain when one partner constantly doubts the other person's intentions. Trust does not mean believing that your partner will never make a mistake. Rather, it means feeling confident that both people are committed to treating each other honestly and respectfully.

Another challenge is unrealistic expectations. Some people enter marriage believing that their partner should always understand them, make them happy, and meet all their emotional needs. Such expectations can place enormous pressure on a relationship. In reality, even healthy couples experience frustration, disappointment, and periods of emotional distance.

Successful couples also learn how to navigate conflict. Disagreements are unavoidable when two people share their lives. The important question is not whether couples argue, but how they deal with those arguments. Criticizing, insulting, or refusing to communicate can damage a relationship, while listening, compromising, and taking responsibility can help couples move forward.

Marriage can also be influenced by factors outside the relationship itself. Financial difficulties, demanding careers, family expectations, cultural differences, and social pressures can all create additional stress. Couples therefore need to develop the ability to adapt to changing circumstances rather than expecting their relationship to remain exactly the same throughout their lives.

Perhaps most importantly, a lasting relationship requires ongoing effort. The excitement of a new relationship may naturally change over time, but that does not necessarily mean love has disappeared. Emotional intimacy can develop in different ways as couples grow older. Spending time together, showing appreciation, supporting one another, and maintaining a sense of partnership can help keep a relationship strong.

So, is love enough?

Probably not.

Love may bring two people together, but trust, communication, respect, commitment, and mutual effort can determine whether they remain together. A successful marriage is not simply something people find; it is something they continue to build.

Reading Comprehension

Choose the Best Answer

1. What is the main idea of the passage?
    a. Love is unnecessary in marriage.
    b. Love is important, but a lasting marriage requires more than love.
    c. Marriage is mainly influenced by financial stability.
2. Why can marriage reveal differences between partners?
    a. Couples have to deal with responsibilities and challenges together.
    b. People usually lose interest in each other after marriage.
    c. Married couples spend less time communicating.
3. According to the passage, what can happen when couples ignore their problems?
    a. The problems usually disappear naturally.
    b. The problems can gradually become more serious.
    c. The relationship automatically becomes stronger.
4. What does the passage suggest about conflict in marriage?
    a. Healthy couples should never disagree.
    b. Disagreements should always be avoided.
    c. The way couples handle disagreements is more important than avoiding them.
5. What does a lasting relationship require, according to the passage?
    a. Constant romantic excitement
    b. Ongoing effort, trust, communication, and respect
    c. Partners having identical personalities and goals

A. True or False

Write T or F. Correct the false statements.

_____ Couples need to communicate honestly about their concerns.

_____ Trust means believing that your partner will never make mistakes.

_____ Unrealistic expectations can put pressure on a relationship.

_____ Disagreements are presented as unavoidable in long-term relationships.

_____ The passage suggests that successful couples never experience emotional distance.

_____ External factors can influence the quality of a marriage.

_____ A lasting relationship requires continuous effort.

Answer the Questions

Answer in complete sentences.

Do you agree that love alone is not enough for marriage? Why?
What expectations do people often have before getting married?
Can unrealistic expectations damage an otherwise healthy relationship?
Should a spouse be expected to meet all of their partner's emotional needs?
Is romantic love more important at the beginning of a relationship than later?

Speaking through Reading

Activity 1: One-Minute Summary

Work in pairs.

Student A: Summarize the reading in one minute.

Student B: Listen carefully and ask two follow-up questions.

Activity 2

Discuss the following questions.

1. Why do people sometimes avoid discussing problems with their partners?
2. Is disagreement necessarily a sign of an unhealthy relationship?
3. What is the difference between healthy disagreement and destructive conflict?

4. Should couples always solve their problems immediately, or is taking time apart sometimes better?
5. Is compromise always necessary in a marriage?

Activity 3: Critical Thinking

Evaluate ideas, support claims with reasons, and defend your position respectfully.

1. How have expectations of marriage changed compared with previous generations?
2. How can financial problems affect a relationship?
3. Should married couples have completely shared finances or some financial independence?
4. How might social media create unrealistic expectations about relationships?

Challenge Question

1. If two people genuinely love each other but have completely different values, goals, and lifestyles, should they stay together?

Homework

Two-Minute Speaking

Speak individually.

Topic

What are your criteria for marriage?

Use at least six expressions from the Reading Toolbox.

Chapter 2 ·

The Science of a Lasting Relationship

Speaking through Listening

The Science of a Lasting Relationship

Think – Pair – Share

Discuss the following questions with your partner.

1. What do you think is the biggest reason marriages fail?
2. Can couples have a strong relationship even if they argue frequently?
3. How important is friendship between married partners?
4. Do you think couples should spend most of their free time together?
5. What does a healthy relationship look like?

Before Listening

Look at the Title

The Science of a Lasting Relationship

Discuss the following questions.

Do you think small everyday actions can affect a marriage?

Why might communication be more important than romantic feelings?

What do you think researchers can learn by observing couples?

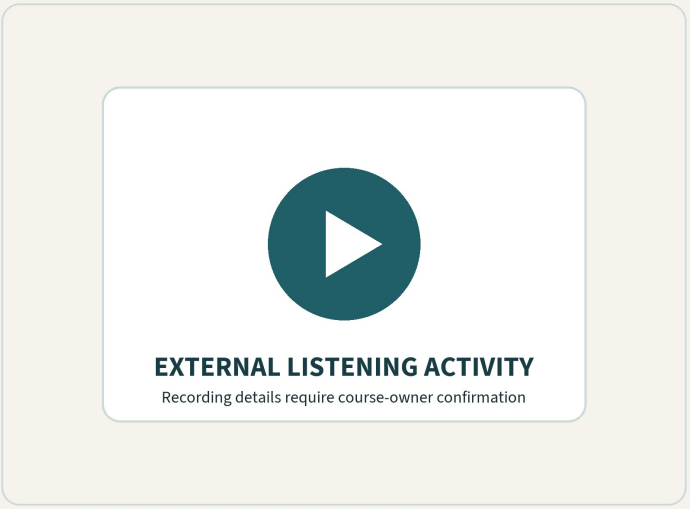
Focus on these useful expressions related to the talk.

Expression / Collocation	Meaning	Example
a thriving relationship	a relationship that is healthy, successful, and developing well	Trust and respect are essential to a thriving relationship.
a fleeting desire	a desire or feeling that lasts only for a short time	Physical attraction can sometimes be a fleeting desire.
take someone for granted	fail to appreciate someone because you assume they will always be there	Couples should avoid taking each other for granted.

Expression / Collocation	Meaning	Example
walk on eggshells	behave very carefully because you are afraid of upsetting someone	You shouldn't have to walk on eggshells around your partner.
build and rebuild trust	develop trust and restore it after it has been damaged	Trust is built through small promises kept over time.
show up for someone	be present and provide support when someone needs you	A good partner shows up for you during difficult times.
give someone the benefit of the doubt	choose to believe that someone had a good reason for their actions	When you don't understand your partner's behavior, give them the benefit of the doubt.
a shared vision	a common idea about the future and what you want to achieve	Couples need a shared vision of the life they want to build.

Listening Strategy

First Viewing



✔ Do not write.

✔ Listen for the main idea.

Ask yourself:

1. What is the speaker trying to convince us to do?

Second Viewing

Take notes.

Focus on key ideas, examples, reasons. Do not try to write every word.

Main Idea	Supporting Details

Listening Comprehension

A. Multiple Choice

Choose the best answer.

1. What is the speaker's main purpose?
    a. To explain why people should avoid marriage
    b. To present six ingredients that can help relationships thrive
    c. To argue that sexual chemistry is the most important part of love
2. How does the speaker distinguish attraction from sexual chemistry?
    a. Attraction lasts longer and involves wanting to continue discovering the other person.
    b. Attraction is completely biological, while sexual chemistry is emotional.
    c. They are essentially the same thing.
3. According to the speaker, what helps build trust?
    a. Grand and expensive apologies
    b. Small promises that are consistently kept
    c. Avoiding difficult conversations
4. What does compassion mean in the speaker's explanation?
    a. Experiencing exactly the same emotions as your partner
    b. Feeling for your partner while maintaining your own emotional stability
    c. Ignoring your partner's emotions to protect yourself
5. What does a shared vision help couples do?
    a. Avoid making compromises completely
    b. Decide where they want to go and prioritize their resources accordingly
    c. Make sure they have identical personalities

B. True or False

Write T (True) or F (False). Correct the false statements.

The speaker's research involved 450 couples.

_____ The couples in the study had all been together for approximately the same amount of time.

_____ The speaker believes attraction is limited to sexual chemistry.

_____ Respect involves not taking your partner for granted.

_____ Trust is built through consistent and reliable behavior.

_____ The speaker says couples should always sacrifice for each other.

_____ A shared vision involves knowing where you want to go as individuals and as a couple.

_____ The speaker argues that loving behaviors are simply automatic once people fall in love.

C. Short Answer

Answer the questions in complete sentences.

1. Can respect exist without love?
2. Is it possible to lose attraction to someone but still have a strong relationship?
3. What everyday behaviors show that someone respects their partner?

Group Discussion

Work in groups of 3–4 students. Discuss the following questions.

1. Why are small promises important for building trust?
2. Is trust easy to rebuild after it has been broken?
3. What is the difference between empathy and compassion?
4. Can being too emotionally involved in your partner's problems become unhealthy?
5. What does it really mean to "show up" for someone?
6. Should married couples have the same long-term goals?
7. What happens when two partners have completely different ideas about their future?
8. Is compromise healthier than sacrifice? Why?
9. Do loving behaviors become less important after people have been together for many years?

Challenge Question

1. The speaker says, “You don’t fall out of love. You fall out of loving.” Do you agree or disagree? Explain your answer with examples.

Chapter 3 ·

What Makes Relationships Work?

Speaking through Discussion

Speaking Toolbox

What Makes Relationships Work?

Study 10 carefully selected collocations, phrasal verbs, and discussion expressions related to the week's topic.

Vocabulary / Collocation	Meaning	Example
maintain a relationship	to keep a relationship strong and healthy	It takes effort to maintain a healthy relationship over many years.
long-term commitment	a serious decision to remain dedicated to someone or something for a long time	Marriage usually involves a long-term commitment.
resolve a conflict	to find a solution to a disagreement	Couples need to learn how to resolve conflicts respectfully.
compromise on something	to accept less than what you originally wanted in order to reach an agreement	They had to compromise on where they would live.
have conflicting goals	to have goals that cannot easily be achieved together	They began to realize that they had conflicting goals for the future.
rebuild trust	to gradually restore confidence after it has been damaged	It can take years to rebuild trust after betrayal.
set boundaries	to clearly communicate what behavior you will or will not accept	Healthy couples should be able to set boundaries without threatening each other.
emotional distance	a lack of emotional closeness between people	They still lived together, but emotional distance had developed between them.

Vocabulary / Collocation	Meaning	Example
deal with disagreement	to manage a difference of opinion	Mature couples learn how to deal with disagreement without becoming disrespectful.
mutual understanding	a situation in which two people understand and respect each other's feelings or opinions	Mutual understanding is essential when partners have different priorities.

Vocabulary Activation

Work in pairs. Choose 10 expressions and create a short conversation using all ten.

Guided Discussion

Work in groups of 3–4 students. Use at least eight expressions from the Speaking Toolbox.

Discussion Questions

1. Do you think attraction naturally changes as people grow older?
2. Can emotional attraction be stronger than physical attraction?
3. Is it possible to love someone deeply without being attracted to them?
4. Why do some people confuse the end of excitement with the end of love?
5. What should couples do when the relationship becomes less exciting?

The Future of Marriage

1. Do you think people's expectations of marriage are becoming unrealistic?
2. Is financial stability necessary for a successful marriage?
3. Should married couples have completely shared goals?
4. How might technology affect marriage in the future?

Challenge Question

1. If two people love each other but their long-term goals are completely incompatible, should they stay together or separate? Defend your position.

The Six-Ingredient Ranking Challenge

Rank the six ingredients from 1 (most important) to 6 (least important).

Rank	Ingredient
___	Attraction
___	Respect
___	Trust
___	Compassion
___	Shared vision
___	Loving behaviors

Discuss:

1. Why did you put your number 1 first?
2. Why did you put your number 6 last?
3. Did everyone in your group agree?
4. Could a marriage survive without your number 1?

After discussing with your group, would you change your ranking?

Speaking Challenge 1

After everything you have discussed in this unit, what is your answer to the question: “Is love enough?”

Give a 1-minute response and support your opinion with at least two reasons and one example.

Chapter 4 ·

Speaking through Research Presentation

Pronunciation Clinic

Skill: Pronouncing the “-ed” Ending

The “-ed” Ending: /t/, /d/, or /ɪd/?

For regular past-tense verbs, the -ed ending is commonly pronounced /t/, /d/, or /ɪd/. These labels describe the ending only; vowel pronunciations in the rest of each word can vary by accent.

1. /t/

After a voiceless consonant other than /t/ (for example, /k/, /p/, /s/, /ʃ/, /tʃ/, or /f/).

liked

kissed

discussed

helped

They discussed their problems.

2. /d/

After a voiced consonant other than /d/, or a vowel sound.

loved

shared

learned

showed

They shared a vision for their future.

3. /ɪd/

Only after /t/ or /d/ sounds.

wanted

needed

respected

committed

They respected each other's boundaries.

Quick Practice

Ask students to put these words into three groups:

loved — respected — trusted — liked — shared — wanted — discussed — needed — helped — showed — kissed — committed

/t/	/d/	/ɪd/

Speaking Challenge 2

Students choose one word from each column and create a sentence about relationships.

For example:

They liked each other, shared similar values, and respected each other's boundaries.

Presentation Toolbox

Academic Presentation Expressions

Expression	Function
I'd like to begin by discussing…	Opening
The purpose of today's presentation is to…	Introducing the topic
Let me start with…	Organizing ideas
One important issue to consider is…	Highlighting information
According to recent research,…	Referring to evidence
For example,…	Giving examples
This suggests that…	Interpreting evidence
On the other hand,…	Presenting a contrasting idea

Expression	Function
To summarize,...	Summarizing
I'd like to leave you with one final thought...	Memorable closing
Thank you for your attention. I'd be happy to answer your questions.	Closing

Research Task

Use reliable sources to research the topic you select below.

Choose one of the following topics.

Use the questions under your chosen topic to guide your research.

1. Is Love Enough for a Successful Marriage?

1. What do psychologists say about love and long-term relationships?
2. What other factors contribute to marital satisfaction?
3. Why might love alone not be enough?

2. Communication and Conflict in Relationships

1. Why do couples experience conflict?
2. What communication strategies can help couples resolve disagreements?
3. What behaviors can make conflict worse?

3. What Makes a Marriage Last?

1. What factors are commonly associated with successful marriages?
2. What behaviors help couples maintain closeness?
3. What can cause relationships to break down?

4. Marriage and Financial Stress

1. How can financial problems affect relationships?
2. Should married couples combine their finances?
3. How can couples reduce financial conflict?

5. Marriage in the Modern World

1. How has marriage changed compared with previous generations?
2. How have technology and social media affected relationships?

3. What challenges do modern couples face?

6. Love across Cultures

1. How do different cultures view marriage?
2. What role do family expectations play?
3. How can cultural differences affect relationships?

Presentation Language

Introducing Your Topic

Today, I'd like to talk about...

The purpose of my presentation is to...

Referring to Evidence

According to research,...

Studies have shown that...

Experts believe that...

Giving Examples

For example,...

One good example is...

This can be seen in...

Consider the case of...

Expressing Opinions

I strongly believe that...

From my perspective,...

It seems to me that...

Concluding

To sum up,...

In conclusion,...

The key message is...

Organizing Your Presentation

Prepare a 4–5 minute presentation using the outline below.

Title

Introduction

1. What question will you answer?

Main Point 1

Example or Evidence

Main Point 2

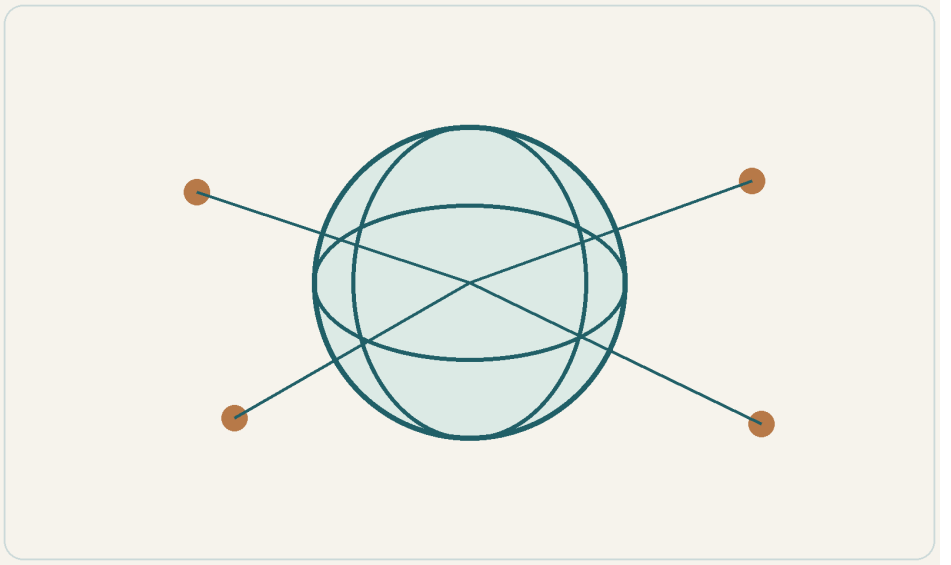
Example or Evidence

Main Point 3

Example or Evidence

Unit 7 ·

Globalization



THINK

Answer the following questions individually.

When you hear the word “globalization,” what is the first thing that comes to your mind?

How has globalization changed your daily life? Give some specific examples.

What things from other countries have become popular in your country? Think about food, clothes, music, movies, technology, or lifestyle.

Chapter 1 ·

The World Is Getting Smaller

Speaking through Reading

Vocabulary Preview

Expression	Meaning	Example
across borders	from one country to another	Technology allows information to move across borders quickly.
international trade	buying and selling goods and services between countries	International trade connects economies around the world.
reach a market	gain access to customers in a particular market	Small businesses can use social media to reach international markets.
enormous opportunities	very large or important chances for success	Globalization can create enormous opportunities for young people.
collaborate across borders	work together with people in other countries	Scientists increasingly collaborate across borders.
local culture	the traditions, beliefs, and lifestyle of a particular community	Global trends can sometimes influence local culture.
compete with	try to be more successful than another person or organization	Small businesses may struggle to compete with multinational companies.
be distributed equally	be shared fairly or in the same way among people	The benefits of economic growth are not always distributed equally.
fuel consumption	the amount of fuel used by vehicles, machines, etc.	International transportation increases fuel consumption.
protect local communities	keep local people, businesses, and traditions safe from harm	Governments may need policies to protect local communities.

Vocabulary Check

Use the correct expression from the box.

across borders — international trade — reach a market — enormous opportunities — collaborate across borders

The internet allows people to communicate _____ almost instantly.

Universities can _____ with researchers from other countries.

_____ has become an important part of the modern global economy.

Social media helps small businesses _____ that they could not access before.

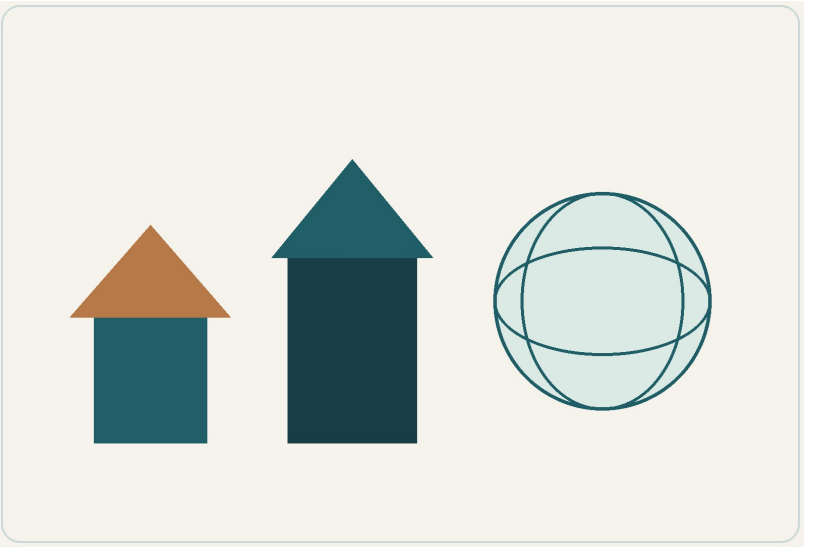
Studying abroad can create _____ for young people.

Before You Read

Discuss.

1. What does the word globalization mean to you?
2. How many products do you use every day that were made in another country?
3. How has the internet changed the way people communicate around the world?

The World Is Getting Smaller



Imagine waking up in Kabul, checking a message from a friend in Australia, drinking coffee produced in another country, wearing clothes manufactured thousands of kilometers away, and then attending an online class with people from different parts of the world.

None of this seems unusual anymore.

A few decades ago, many of these experiences would have been difficult, expensive, or even impossible. Today, technology, transportation, international trade, and the internet have made it easier for people, products, ideas, and information to move across borders. This process is known as globalization.

Globalization has connected countries in ways that were once unimaginable. A company in one country can design a product, manufacture it in another, advertise it through a global platform, and sell it to customers almost anywhere in the world. A student can take an online course from a university thousands of kilometers away. A small business can reach international customers through social media.

This growing connection can create enormous opportunities. People can access products, information, education, and employment opportunities that were previously unavailable to them. Businesses can enter new markets and reach millions of potential customers. Scientists and researchers can collaborate across borders to solve problems that affect the entire planet.

Globalization has also changed culture. Music, movies, food, fashion, and languages now travel rapidly from one country to another. Someone in Kabul

can listen to Korean music, watch an American television series, eat Italian food, and communicate with someone in Japan—all in the same day.

However, globalization is not entirely positive. Some people worry that local cultures and traditions may become weaker as global trends become more popular. Small businesses may also struggle to compete with large international companies. In addition, the benefits of globalization are not distributed equally. While some people gain new opportunities, others may lose jobs when companies move production to countries where labor is cheaper.

There are also environmental concerns. More international transportation means more fuel consumption and emissions. The production of cheap products for global markets can contribute to pollution and waste.

For these reasons, globalization is neither simply good nor bad. It is a complex process with both benefits and costs. The real challenge is finding ways to enjoy the advantages of global connections while protecting local communities, cultures, workers, and the environment.

Perhaps the world is not literally becoming smaller. Instead, distance is becoming less important. A person can now communicate, work, study, and build relationships with people thousands of kilometers away. The question is no longer whether globalization will affect our lives. It already does.

The more important question is:

What kind of globalized world do we want to create?

Reading Comprehension

Choose the Best Answer

1. What is the main idea of the passage?
    a. Globalization has only negative effects on local cultures.
    b. Globalization has connected the world and created both opportunities and challenges.
    c. Technology is the only cause of globalization.
2. According to the passage, what has helped globalization grow?
    a. Technology, transportation, trade, and the internet
    b. Local traditions and small businesses
    c. Reduced communication between countries

3. How can globalization benefit businesses?
   a. It prevents them from competing internationally.
   b. It allows them to reach new markets and customers.
   c. It forces them to sell products locally.
4. Why are some people concerned about globalization?
   a. They believe international communication is impossible.
   b. They are concerned about local cultures, jobs, inequality, and the environment.
   c. They believe people should stop using technology.
5. What does the writer mean by saying that "distance is becoming less important"?
   a. Physical distance no longer exists.
   b. People can communicate and interact across long distances more easily.
   c. People no longer need to travel.

B. True or False

Write T or F. Correct the false statements.

_____ Globalization has made it easier for products and information to cross borders.

_____ Only large international companies can benefit from globalization.

_____ Globalization has influenced culture, including music, food, fashion, and language.

_____ Everyone benefits equally from globalization.

_____ The passage presents globalization as completely positive.

_____ International transportation can create environmental problems.

_____ The writer believes globalization is already affecting our lives.

Answer the Questions

Answer in complete sentences.

What is one product you use that comes from another country?

What foreign foods, music, movies, or fashion are popular in your community?

How has the internet made your life more international?

Do you communicate with people from other countries? How?
Would your daily life be very different without globalization?

Speaking through Reading

Activity 1: One-Minute Summary

Work in pairs.

Student A: Summarize the reading in one minute.

Student B: Listen carefully and ask two follow-up questions.

Activity 2

Discuss the following questions.

1. What is the biggest advantage of globalization?
2. What is the biggest disadvantage?
3. Does globalization create more opportunities for young people?
4. Can globalization help developing countries? Why or why not?
5. Should countries protect local businesses from international competition?

Activity 3: Critical Thinking

1. Can globalization make different cultures more similar?
2. Is cultural change necessarily a bad thing?
3. What aspects of your culture should never disappear?
4. Can someone be a global citizen while maintaining a strong local identity?

Challenge Question

1. If globalization eventually made most countries culturally similar, would that be a positive or negative development?

Homework

Two-Minute Speaking

Speak individually.

Topic

1. Is globalization bringing the world together, or is it simply changing the way our differences appear?

Use at least six expressions from the Reading Toolbox.

Chapter 2 ·

Navigating Our Global Future

Speaking through Listening

Navigating Our Global Future

Think – Pair – Share

Discuss the following questions with your partner.

1. When you think about the future, what makes you feel optimistic?
2. What makes you feel worried about the future?
3. Do you think technological progress always makes people's lives better?
4. What could happen if the world's countries become increasingly interconnected?
5. Do you think people will live and work differently in 2030 than they do today?

Before Listening

Prediction

Look at these words before watching:

inequality — technology — resilience — migration — genetics — globalization

1. What do you think the speaker will say about each one?

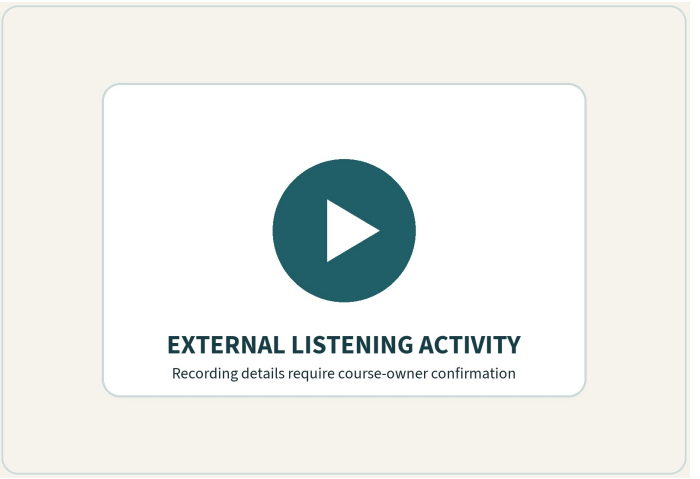
Focus on these useful expressions related to the talk.

Expression	Meaning	Example
get it wrong	to make an incorrect judgment or prediction	Even experts can get it wrong when they try to predict the future.
unleash new potential	to allow new possibilities or abilities to develop	New technologies could unleash new potential in medicine and education.
be left out	to be excluded from an opportunity or benefit	Some communities feel left out of the benefits of globalization.

Expression	Meaning	Example
growing inequality	an increasing difference between groups in wealth, opportunities, or living conditions	Rapid economic growth can sometimes lead to growing inequality.
build resilience	to develop the ability to survive, adapt to, and recover from difficulties	Countries need to build resilience against future pandemics and economic crises.
huge leaps in technology	very large or rapid advances in technology	We have seen huge leaps in technology over the last few decades.
regenerative medicine	medicine that aims to repair or replace damaged body parts	Scientists hope that regenerative medicine will allow doctors to repair damaged organs.
attract talent	to encourage skilled and capable people to come to a country, company, or organization	Many countries compete to attract talent from around the world.

Listening Strategy

First Viewing



✔ Do not write.

✔ Listen for the main idea.

Ask yourself:

1. What is the speaker trying to convince us to do?

Second Viewing

Take notes.

Focus on key ideas, examples, reasons. Do not try to write every word.

Main Idea	Supporting Details

Listening Comprehension

A. Multiple Choice

Choose the best answer.

1. Why does Goldin say the future is unpredictable?
    A. People are not interested in the future.
    B. Even experts and major institutions frequently make incorrect predictions.
    C. Technology has stopped developing.
2. What does Goldin identify as two “Achilles heels” of globalization?
    A. Technology and migration
    B. Growing inequality and complexity
    C. Poverty and unemployment
3. What does Goldin mean by “systemic risk”?
    A. A problem that affects only one individual
    B. A problem that can spread through interconnected systems
    C. A risk caused only by technology
4. What does Goldin predict about computing by 2030?
    A. Computers will become less powerful.
    B. Computing power will improve enormously for the same price.
    C. Computers will disappear.
5. What concern does Goldin raise about genetic technology?
    A. It may become available only to wealthy people.
    B. It will completely stop medical development.
    C. It will make people live shorter lives.

6. Why does Goldin believe migration may become increasingly important?

   A. Countries will need people to support their economies and aging populations.

   B. People will no longer want to live in their own countries.

   C. Technology will eliminate all national borders.

7. Which of the following does Goldin mention as a systemic risk?

   A. Fashion

   B. Climate change

   C. Tourism

8. What does Goldin believe humanity needs to do?

   A. Stop technological development.

   B. Allow only wealthy countries to develop technology.

   C. Develop new ways of collectively managing global challenges.

B. True or False

Write T or F. Correct the false statements.

_____ Goldin believes globalization is becoming less complex.

_____ Life expectancy has increased significantly over the previous 40 years.

_____ Goldin believes globalization has benefited everyone equally.

_____ Technology could create enormous opportunities in medicine.

_____ Goldin is concerned that advanced genetic technologies could increase inequality.

_____ He believes migration may become more important in the future.

_____ Climate change and pandemics are examples of systemic risks.

_____ Goldin believes existing global governance structures are fully prepared for future challenges.

_____ He believes collective action can produce extraordinary results.

_____ Goldin ends with a completely pessimistic view of the future.

C. Short Answer

Answer the questions in complete sentences.

1. Which prediction in the video surprised you the most?

2. Do you agree that globalization's greatest strength could also become its greatest weakness? Why?

3. Goldin says that globalization has not been inclusive. What does this mean?

Group Discussion

Work in groups of 3–4 students. Discuss the following questions.

1. Should advanced medical and genetic technologies be available to everyone?
2. If technology allows people to live much longer, how might society change?
3. Would longer life expectancy be a blessing or a problem?
4. Do you agree that migration will become more important in the future?
5. Which systemic risk mentioned in the video worries you the most?
6. Do you think individual countries can solve global problems on their own?
7. Goldin says that humanity needs “collective wisdom.” What do you think he means?

Challenge Question

1. If you could give one piece of advice to the world’s leaders about the future, what would it be?

Chapter 3 ·

Globalization: Opportunity or Threat?

Speaking through Discussion

Speaking Toolbox

Globalization: Opportunity or Threat?

Study 10 carefully selected collocations, phrasal verbs, and discussion expressions related to the week's topic.

Vocabulary / Expression	Meaning	Example
take a position	to choose and express a particular opinion about an issue	Before the debate, students had to take a position on globalization.
to some extent	partly, but not completely	I agree to some extent, but globalization also creates serious problems.
look at something differently	have a different way of understanding or thinking about something	I understand your argument, but I look at the issue differently.
support an argument	to provide reasons or evidence that make an argument stronger	You need to use examples to support your argument.
create opportunities	to make new possibilities for success or development available	Globalization can create opportunities for people in developing countries.
widen the gap	to make the difference between two groups larger	Unequal access to technology can widen the gap between rich and poor.
benefit from	to gain an advantage or positive result from something	Not everyone benefits from globalization equally.
pose a threat to	to create a possible danger or problem for something	Global competition can pose a threat to small local businesses.
address a problem	to take action to deal with a problem	Governments need to address the problem of economic inequality.

Vocabulary / Expression	Meaning	Example
take responsibility for	to accept the duty of dealing with something	Countries should take responsibility for reducing environmental damage.

Vocabulary Activation

Work in pairs. Choose 10 expressions and create a short conversation using all ten.

Guided Discussion

Work in groups of 3–4 students. Use at least eight expressions from the Speaking Toolbox.

Discussion Questions

It is the year 2050. You are members of an international committee responsible for designing a better global future.

Your committee has a limited budget and can focus on only three areas.

Choose three:

Climate change

Artificial intelligence

Global education

Economic inequality

Genetic technology

Migration

Global healthcare

Environmental protection

Employment

International peace

1. Which three should receive the most attention?
2. Why are they more important than the others?
3. What should governments do?
4. What should individuals do?

What Does This Mean?

Then discuss:

1. How can globalization be its own strength and weakness?
2. What is the biggest benefit of globalization?
3. What is its biggest danger?
4. Can we enjoy the benefits without creating the risks?
5. Who should be responsible for managing those risks?

Speaking Challenge

After everything you have discussed in this unit, what is your answer to the question:

"What is one prediction about the future that you strongly agree with, and one that you disagree with?"

Give a 1-minute response and support your opinion with at least two reasons and one example.

Chapter 4 ·

Globalization: Opportunity or Threat?

Speaking through Research Presentation

Pronunciation Clinic

Skill: The /θ/ and /ð/ Sounds: “th” Is Not Always the Same

English th represents two different sounds:

/θ/ — voiceless TH

Your vocal cords do not vibrate.

think

Examples:

think

threat

three

growth

/ð/ — voiced TH

Your vocal cords vibrate.

these (theez)

Examples:

these

those

the

they

although

other

Quick Test

Put your fingers lightly on your throat.

Say:

think — this

You should feel no vibration with /θ/ but vibration with /ð/.

Common Problem

Students sometimes pronounce:

think → sink

three → tree

this → dis

those → dose

Mouth Position

Put the tip of your tongue lightly between your teeth.

Don't bite your tongue.

Blow air gently for /θ/.

Add your voice for /ð/.

Practice

Read these pairs:

think — this

three — these

threat — that

thought — though

through — those

Then read:

These three things threaten the future of globalization.

Although technology creates opportunities, there are also threats.

Challenge

Say:

"I think these three things could change the future."

First slowly, then naturally.

Presentation Toolbox

Academic Presentation Expressions

Expression	Function
I'd like to begin by discussing...	Opening
The purpose of today's presentation is to...	Introducing the topic
Let me start with...	Organizing ideas
One important issue to consider is...	Highlighting information
According to recent research,...	Referring to evidence
For example,...	Giving examples
This suggests that...	Interpreting evidence
On the other hand,...	Presenting a contrasting idea
To summarize,...	Summarizing
I'd like to leave you with one final thought...	Memorable closing
Thank you for your attention. I'd be happy to answer your questions.	Closing

Research Task

Research your topic using reliable sources.

Use the questions below to guide your research:

Globalization: Opportunity or Threat?

Consider these questions:

1. What are the major benefits of globalization?
2. What are its major disadvantages?
3. Who benefits most from globalization?
4. Who may be left out?
5. How has technology accelerated globalization?
6. How can globalization affect local cultures?
7. How can globalization contribute to inequality?

8. What can governments do to make globalization more inclusive?
9. What role should individuals play?
10. What kind of global future do you want to see?

Presentation Language

Introducing Your Topic

Today, I'd like to talk about...

The purpose of my presentation is to...

Referring to Evidence

According to research,...

Studies have shown that...

Experts believe that...

Giving Examples

For example,...

One good example is...

This can be seen in...

Consider the case of...

Expressing Opinions

I strongly believe that...

From my perspective,...

It seems to me that...

Concluding

To sum up,...

In conclusion,...

The key message is...

Organizing Your Presentation

Prepare a 4–5 minute presentation using the outline below.

Title

Introduction

1. What question will you answer?

Main Point 1

Example or Evidence

Main Point 2

Example or Evidence

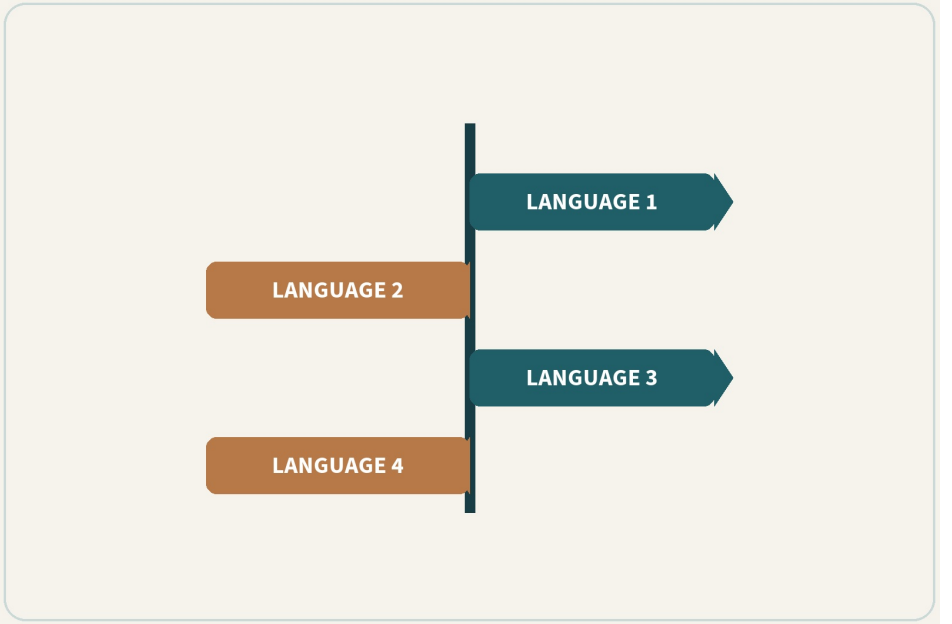
Main Point 3

Example or Evidence

Conclusion

Unit 8 ·

Lingua Franca



THINK

Answer the following questions individually.

What languages do you use the most in your everyday communication?

Why do you learn English?

What does Lingua Franca mean to you?

Chapter 1 ·

English: From a Local Language to a Global Lingua Franca

Speaking through Reading

Vocabulary Preview

Expression	Meaning	Example
lingua franca	a common language used between people with different native languages	English is often used as a lingua franca at international conferences.
Influential	having the power to affect people or events	The United States has been highly influential in global culture.
Expansion	the process of becoming larger or spreading	The expansion of the British Empire helped spread English.
Establish	to create or set up something officially	The company established offices in several countries.
Commerce	the activity of buying and selling goods and services	English became important in international commerce.
Accelerate	to make something happen faster	Technology accelerated the spread of English.
Adapt	to change something so that it works in a new situation	Languages adapt when speakers from different cultures use them.
variety of English	a particular form of English associated with a region or community	Indian English is an important variety of English.
linguistic diversity	the existence of many different languages	Globalization should not destroy linguistic diversity.
ancestral language	a language traditionally spoken by a person's ancestors	Some young people are losing their ancestral language.

Vocabulary Check

"English is no longer simply the property of native speakers."

Use this idea to discuss the title above. Use as many vocabulary expressions as you can.

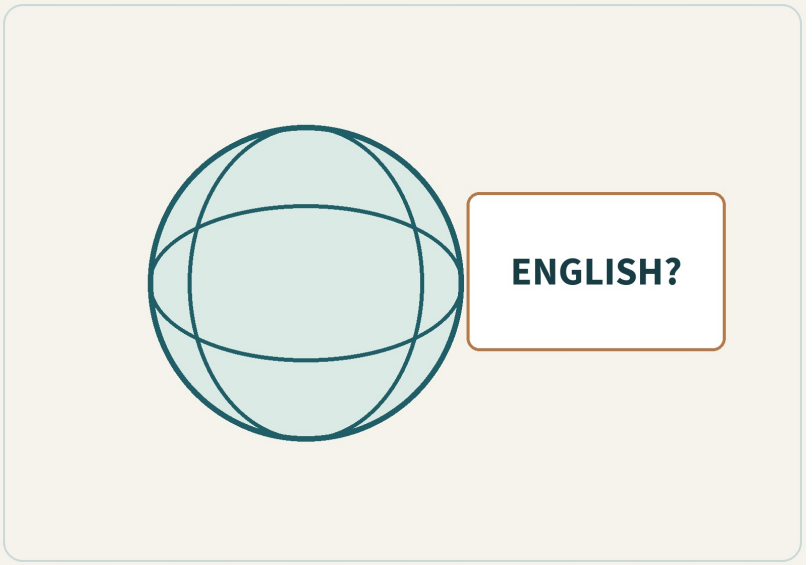
I believe English belongs to everyone who uses it because...

Before You Read

Discuss.

1. How many countries do you think use English as an official or widely used language?
2. What areas do you think English has the strongest influence on?
3. Do you think everyone in the world should learn English?

English: From a Local Language to a Global Lingua Franca



A few centuries ago, English was simply one language among many. It was spoken mainly by people in England and parts of the British Isles. Today, however, English is used in almost every corner of the world. People use it in international business, science, aviation, education, entertainment, tourism and online communication. But how did a language that began in a relatively small part of Europe become so influential?

The story is complicated. One important factor was the expansion of the British Empire. As Britain established colonies and trading networks around the world, English traveled with its institutions, administration, education and commerce. In many places, English became an important language for government and education.

However, the story did not end with the decline of the British Empire. During the twentieth century, the economic, political, scientific and cultural influence of the United States helped strengthen the international position of English. American companies expanded internationally, Hollywood films reached global audiences, and American universities and research institutions became highly influential.

Technology accelerated this process even further. As the internet developed, English became one of its dominant languages. International companies, researchers and technology professionals increasingly used English to communicate across national borders. A person in Afghanistan might watch a video created in the United States, read an article written by a researcher in Japan, and communicate online with someone in Germany—all using English.

But there is an important twist.

English is no longer controlled entirely by the people who speak it as a first language. Millions of people use English as an additional language, and they naturally adapt it to their own cultures and needs. English spoken in India may sound different from English spoken in Nigeria. Singaporean English has its own characteristics, while many other countries have developed their own varieties.

This has led to an interesting question:

Who owns English?

If most English conversations in the world take place between people who are not native speakers, perhaps English should no longer be viewed simply as the property of Britain, the United States, Australia or other traditionally English-speaking countries.

Instead, English may increasingly belong to everyone who uses it.

This does not mean that native-speaker varieties are disappearing. British, American, Australian and other varieties of English remain highly influential. However, the global spread of English has created a much larger linguistic community.

There is also a darker side to the story. The global importance of English can create advantages for people who have access to good English education while creating disadvantages for those who do not. English can open doors to universities, international jobs and information, but it can also become a barrier.

At the same time, some people worry about what happens to local languages when one international language becomes extremely powerful. If younger generations increasingly use English instead of their ancestral languages, some languages may gradually lose speakers.

Therefore, the global rise of English is both an opportunity and a challenge.

English can connect people who might otherwise struggle to communicate. But global communication should not require the world to abandon its linguistic diversity.

Perhaps the most interesting future is not one in which everyone speaks exactly the same English.

Perhaps it is one in which people use English to communicate globally while continuing to protect the languages and identities that make their communities unique.

Reading Comprehension

Choose the Best Answer

1. What is the main purpose of the reading?
    - A. To explain why English is difficult to learn
    - B. To explain how English became globally influential and discuss its consequences
    - C. To prove that English is better than other languages
    - D. To compare British and American English
2. What was one important reason English spread internationally?
    - A. British expansion and colonialism
    - B. The invention of smartphones
    - C. American tourism
    - D. Social media
3. What helped strengthen English during the twentieth century?
    - A. The decline of universities
    - B. The economic and cultural influence of the United States
    - C. The disappearance of local languages
    - D. The invention of television in Britain

4. According to the reading, what did technology do?

    A. It reduced the importance of English.

    B. It made international communication less necessary.

    C. It accelerated the global use of English.

    D. It replaced English with one universal language.

5. Why does the writer ask, “Who owns English?”

    A. Because English has become expensive to learn

    B. Because millions of non-native speakers use and shape the language

    C. Because Britain wants to control English

    D. Because dictionaries are privately owned

Answer the Questions

1. What is a lingua franca?
2. How did the British Empire contribute to the spread of English?
3. How did the United States strengthen the position of English?
4. Why has the internet increased the importance of English?
5. How can non-native speakers influence English?
6. Why can English education create both opportunities and disadvantages?
7. What concern does the reading raise about local languages?
8. What does the writer mean by saying that English may “belong to everyone who uses it”?

Discussion Questions: Answer in complete sentences.

Why do you think English became more internationally important than many other languages?
Is English a language of communication or a language of power?
Do you think non-native speakers should be expected to speak English exactly like native speakers?
Can someone speak “good English” even if their pronunciation is very different from American or British English?
What advantages does English give young people in Afghanistan?

Speaking through Reading

Activity 1: One-Minute Summary

Work in pairs.

Student A: Summarize the reading in one minute.

Student B: Listen carefully and ask two follow-up questions.

Activity 2

Discuss the following questions.

1. Could English ever become less important internationally? Why?
2. Should schools focus more on English or on protecting students' native languages?
3. Is it possible to promote English without damaging local languages?
4. Who should decide what "correct English" is?
5. If 80% of the world's English speakers were non-native speakers, would you still call English an "English-speaking world's language"?

Activity 3: Critical Thinking

Divide into groups and consider this situation:

It is the year 2050. English is still the world's most widely used international language—but 90% of its users are non-native speakers.

Your group must decide:

What Should English in 2050 Look Like?

Choose one:

A. It should remain close to British/American English.

B. There should be a new international form of English.

C. Every country should be free to develop its own version.

D. It doesn't matter what English looks like as long as people understand each other.

Then defend your position.

Final Question

1. If English is the world's lingua franca, is the goal to speak English "correctly" — or simply to communicate successfully?

Chapter 2 ·

English Without Borders

Speaking through Listening

English Without Borders

Think – Pair – Share

Discuss the following questions with your partner.

1. How important is English in your education?
2. Has English ever opened a door for you?
3. Has lack of English ever prevented someone from getting an opportunity?
4. Do you think your English represents your identity?

Before Listening

1. What makes someone's English good?
    A. Native-like pronunciation
    B. Perfect grammar
    C. A large vocabulary
    D. Clear and effective communication

Choose one and explain your choice.

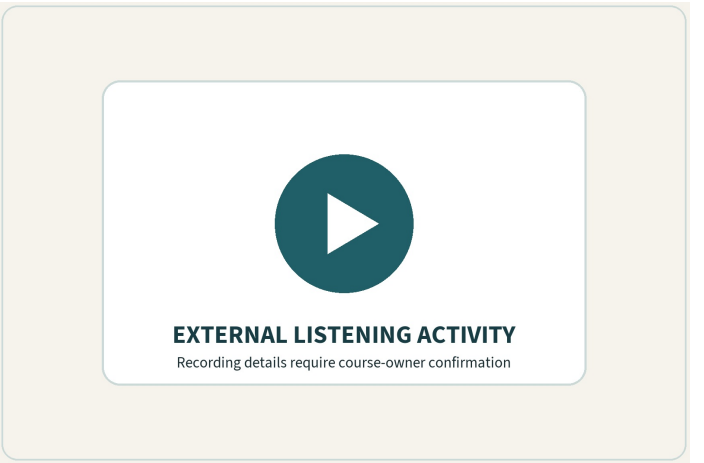
Focus on these useful expressions related to the talk.

Vocabulary / Expression	Meaning	Example
language loss	the disappearance of a language	Language loss can also mean the loss of cultural knowledge.
Unprecedented	never happening before or happening at an unusually high level	Languages are dying at an unprecedented rate.
morph into	to gradually change into something different	English teaching has morphed into a massive international business.

Vocabulary / Expression	Meaning	Example
Bandwagon	a popular activity that many people join because it is becoming successful	English education has become a global bandwagon.
linguistic ability	someone's ability to use or understand a language	A person's linguistic ability does not necessarily show their intelligence.
Gatekeeper	a person or system that controls access to something	English teachers can become gatekeepers to higher education.
self-fulfilling prophecy	a belief or expectation that helps cause itself to become true	The English requirement can become a self-fulfilling prophecy because more research is then produced in English.
Arbitrary	based on a choice rather than a clear logical reason	She argues that equating intelligence with English knowledge is arbitrary.

Listening Strategy

First Viewing



✔ Do not write.

✔ Listen for the main idea.

Ask yourself:

1. What is the speaker trying to convince us to do?

Second Viewing

Take notes.

Focus on key ideas, examples, reasons. Do not try to write every word.

Main Idea	Supporting Details

Listening Comprehension

A. Multiple Choice

Choose the best answer.

1. What did Ryan's friend's students teach her in the garden?
    A. How to grow vegetables
    B. Arabic words for local plants and their uses
    C. How to teach English vocabulary
    D. Traditional English medicine
2. Where did the students get their knowledge about the plants?
    A. From their teachers
    B. From books
    C. From their grandparents and great-grandparents
    D. From the Internet
3. According to Ryan, what has English teaching become?
    A. A small school subject
    B. A declining profession
    C. A massive international business
    D. A completely unnecessary subject
4. Why do many people want an English education?
    A. They believe it gives them access to better educational and professional opportunities.
    B. They want to travel to Britain.
    C. They want to become English teachers.
    D. They want to replace their native languages.

5. Why does Ryan criticize some English-language requirements?

   A. They are too easy.

   B. They can prevent talented people from pursuing their dreams.

   C. They are only used in the UK.

   D. They do not test grammar.

6. What does Ryan mean when she calls English teachers “gatekeepers”?

   A. They protect English from other languages.

   B. They decide whether students meet the language requirements for certain opportunities.

   C. They control international universities.

   D. They teach students how to pass through airports.

7. Why does Ryan mention the Islamic Golden Age?

   A. To show the historical importance of translation

   B. To explain where English originated

   C. To criticize Arabic education

   D. To discuss the history of universities

8. Why does Ryan mention Einstein?

   A. To show that Einstein was fluent in English

   B. To show that brilliant people did not always need to pass English tests to contribute to knowledge

   C. To explain how TOEFL was created

   D. To demonstrate the importance of English pronunciation

9. What problem does Ryan identify with English tests?

   A. They are too short.

   B. They are difficult for native speakers.

   C. Their fees can be prohibitive for poor people.

   D. They test too many languages.

10. What is Ryan’s overall attitude toward English?

    A. She believes English should disappear.

    B. She is completely against teaching English.

    C. She supports English as a global language but opposes using it as a barrier.

    D. She believes everyone should speak only English.

Group Discussion

Work in groups of 3–4 students. Discuss the following questions.

1. What knowledge exists in Afghanistan that is mainly passed down through local languages?
2. What could be lost if a local language disappears?
3. Do Afghan students sometimes feel that English ability = intelligence?
4. Can someone be an excellent doctor, engineer, teacher, farmer, or businessperson without speaking excellent English?
5. Has English opened opportunities for young Afghans? How?
6. Can English also create inequality between people who have access to English education and those who don't?

Mini Debate

"English proficiency should NOT be a requirement for university admission."

Split the class into two groups.

Group A — Agree

Prepare 3 arguments supporting the statement.

Group B — Disagree

Prepare 3 arguments against it.

Use at least two expressions from the Vocabulary Preview, such as:

linguistic ability

gatekeeper

self-fulfilling prophecy

Chapter 3 ·

WHO OWNS ENGLISH?

Speaking through Discussion

Speaking Toolbox

WHO OWNS ENGLISH?

Study 10 carefully selected collocations, phrasal verbs, and discussion expressions related to the week's topic.

Vocabulary / Collocation	Meaning	Example
use English as a lingua franca	to use English to communicate with people who speak different first languages	Many international professionals use English as a lingua franca.
communicate across cultures	to exchange ideas successfully between people from different cultural backgrounds	English allows people to communicate across cultures.
bridge a language gap	to help people communicate when they do not share the same first language	A common language can bridge a language gap.
express an idea clearly	to communicate an idea in a way that is easy to understand	Good speakers can express their ideas clearly even when English is not their first language.
adapt to different accents	to become comfortable understanding different ways of pronouncing English	International students need to adapt to different accents.
be exposed to English	to regularly hear, read, or use English	Students who are exposed to English every day usually become more confident.
overcome a language barrier	to find a way to communicate despite differences in language	English can help international researchers overcome a language barrier.
place a premium on	to consider something especially valuable or important	Many universities place a premium on English proficiency.

Vocabulary / Collocation	Meaning	Example
equate A with B	to consider two things to be essentially the same	We should not equate English proficiency with intelligence.
be judged by one's English	to have one's ability or intelligence evaluated based on English ability	People should not be judged by their English alone.

Vocabulary Activation

Work in pairs. Choose 10 expressions and create a short conversation using all ten.

Guided Discussion

Work in groups of 3–4 students. Use at least eight expressions from the Speaking Toolbox.

Discussion Questions

1. Why has English become such an effective lingua franca?
2. Do you think English really helps people communicate across cultures?
3. Can English completely bridge a language gap, or are cultural differences still a problem?
4. Is it more important to speak English accurately or to express an idea clearly?
5. How can people become better at adapting to different accents?
6. Does being exposed to English automatically make someone a better speaker?
7. What is the best way to overcome a language barrier?
8. Should international universities place a premium on English proficiency?

The Future of English

1. Can someone have excellent academic knowledge but poor English?
2. Why do people sometimes equate English ability with intelligence?
3. Should a student's academic ability be judged separately from their English ability?
4. Should international students be judged by their English when applying to university?
5. Do English tests sometimes create opportunities, or can they also create barriers?

6. Should every university student be required to reach a certain level of English?

Speaking Challenge

1. If a brilliant scientist has weak English but has discovered something that could save millions of lives, should an English-language university be allowed to reject that scientist because of their English?

Defend your position.

Chapter 4 ·

Speaking through Research Presentation

Pronunciation Clinic

Skill: The Schwa /ə/ — Making Unstressed Vowels Natural

A schwa /ə/ is a reduced vowel found in many unstressed syllables in English. Whether a vowel is reduced, and how it sounds, varies by accent and speaking context.

Not every unstressed vowel is a schwa, and clear speech does not require imitating one accent. Use the model chosen for class and focus on being understood.

The Schwa in Common Words

Listen to each example in the chosen model accent and notice which unstressed vowel, if any, is reduced to /ə/.

about → /əˈbaʊt/

around → /əˈraʊnd/

support → /səˈpɔːrt/

today → /təˈdeɪ/

ago → /əˈgoʊ/

perhaps → /pərˈhæps/

In many accents, the first vowel in “about” is reduced; other realizations occur. Compare the chosen model rather than treating one pronunciation as the only correct form.

The Schwa in Academic Vocabulary

Listen to these useful topic words in the chosen model accent; note any unstressed syllable you hear as /ə/.

globalization → /ˌgləʊbəlaɪˈzeɪʃən/

communication → /kəˌmjuːnɪˈkeɪʃən/

international → /ˌɪntəˈnæʃənəl/

education → /ˌedʒəˈkeɪʃən/

linguistic → /lɪŋˈgwɪstɪk/

professional → /prəˈfeʃənəl/

cultural → /ˈkʌltʃərəl/

different → /ˈdɪfrənt/

Unstressed vowels are often reduced in connected speech, but the pattern varies by accent, word, and speaking context.

The Schwa in Function Words

The schwa is particularly common in weak forms:

In connected speech, words such as “to,” “a,” “the,” “for,” “of,” and “can” may be reduced; the exact form varies by accent and context.

Compare:

I want to learn English.

Natural speech:

In some accents, the word “to” is reduced in this sentence; compare it with the model used in class.

And:

English is a global language.

Natural speech:

In some accents, the article “a” is reduced here; compare it with the model used in class.

The purpose is not to speak unclearly. The purpose is to make the important words stand out naturally.

Quick Practice

In the chosen model accent, underline any unstressed syllable you hear as /ə/. Do not treat differences across accents as errors.

about

international

communication

education

professional

globalization

cultural

support

Say the words first carefully, then at a natural pace in the chosen model accent. Compare where vowel reduction occurs.

Presentation Toolbox

Academic Presentation Expressions

Expression	Function
I'd like to begin by discussing…	Opening
The purpose of today's presentation is to…	Introducing the topic
Let me start with…	Organizing ideas
One important issue to consider is…	Highlighting information
According to recent research,…	Referring to evidence
For example,…	Giving examples
This suggests that…	Interpreting evidence
On the other hand,…	Presenting a contrasting idea
To summarize,…	Summarizing
I'd like to leave you with one final thought…	Memorable closing
Thank you for your attention. I'd be happy to answer your questions.	Closing

Research Task

Use reliable sources to research the topic you select below.

Choose one of the following topics.

Use the questions under your chosen topic to guide your research.

1. Is English Really a Global Language?

1. Why has English become an international language?
2. Why do people from different countries use English to communicate?
3. What are the advantages and disadvantages of having one global language?

2. Who Owns English?

1. Should English belong to native speakers?
2. What happens when millions of non-native speakers use and change English?
3. Should there be one "correct" form of international English?

3. Does English Proficiency Equal Intelligence?

1. Why do people sometimes associate English ability with intelligence?
2. Can someone be highly intelligent but have weak English?
3. Should universities judge academic ability separately from language ability?

4. English as a Barrier to Education

1. Can English-language requirements prevent talented students from studying abroad?
2. Are English tests always fair?
3. How could universities evaluate students more fairly?

5. The Future of English

1. How might English change over the next 30 years?
2. Will English continue to be the world's main international language?
3. Could another language eventually become more influential?

6. Language Diversity and Globalization

1. Why are some languages disappearing?
2. What is lost when a language disappears?
3. Can globalization and language diversity exist together?

Presentation Language

Introducing Your Topic

Today, I'd like to talk about...

The purpose of my presentation is to...

Referring to Evidence

According to research,...

Studies have shown that...

Experts believe that...

Giving Examples

For example,...

One good example is...

This can be seen in...

Consider the case of...

Expressing Opinions

I strongly believe that...

From my perspective,...

It seems to me that...

Concluding

To sum up,...

In conclusion,...

The key message is...

Organizing Your Presentation

Prepare a 4–5 minute presentation using the outline below.

Title

Introduction

1. What question will you answer?

Main Point 1

Example or Evidence

Main Point 2

Example or Evidence

Main Point 3

Example or Evidence

Selected Research References

These references support the qualified research claims cited in the readings. They do not constitute publication, rights, or course-owner clearance.

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